2026 PRELIMS 99% MASTERY · CONSOLIDATED CHAPTER-WISE FACTS

ANCIENT INDIA

प्राचीन भारत का इतिहास — संपूर्ण उच्च-प्राथमिकता संकलन

Stone Age, Harappan Civilization, Vedic Literature & Philosophy, Mahajanapadas, Mauryan Empire, Gupta Era, Sangam Age, Dynastic Inscriptions & Numismatics.

UPPCS & UKPCS Prelims 2026 • High-Yield Master Revision Series • 99% Coverage Edition

Ancient India — Master Chapter Index

Consolidated High-Yield Revision Matrix • All 16 Chapters

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Chapter 01: 00 — Executive Bird's-Eye Master Matrix

★ UPPCS & UKPCS Prelims Daily Fact Dump · Active Recall Cheat-Sheet

Exam Focus: UPPSC Prelims (Paper 1), UKPSC Prelims (Paper 1), RO/ARO, BEO
Frequency: Daily morning read (15–20 mins)
Question Types Covered: Match the Following, Chronological ordering, Inscriptions vs Kings, Ashoka's 14 Major Rock Edicts, Shad-Darshana, Vedic assemblies (Sabha, Samiti, Vidatha), Vedic terms & 12 Ratnins, Mauryan & Gupta officers (Tirthas, Adhyakshas, Kumaramatya), Ancient taxes (Bhaga, Bali, Sita, Hiranya, Udranga), Land classifications, Marriage types, Ancient ports & coins, Dynasties & founders.

1. Indus Valley Civilization (IVC) Master Matrix

SITE	LOCATION / STATE	RIVER	EXCAVATOR & YEAR	KEY UNIQUE FINDINGS / EXAM TRIGGERS
Harappa	Sahiwal (Punjab, Pak)	**Ravi** (Left bank)	Daya Ram Sahni (1921)	6 granaries in 2 rows, Coffin burial (R-37 & H cemetery), Sandstone torso of nude male, Copper bullock cart
Mohenjodaro (*Mound of Dead*)	Larkana (Sindh, Pak)	**Indus** (Right bank)	R.D. Banerjee (1922)	**Great Bath**, **Great Granary** (largest building of Mohenjodaro), **Bronze Dancing Girl** (lost wax technique), Steatite Bearded Priest, Pashupati seal, Piece of woven cotton
Lothal	Ahmedabad (Gujarat)	**Bhogava**	S.R. Rao (1954/57)	**Tidal Dockyard** (artificial brick basin), Rice husk, Bead factory, Fire altars, Terracotta horse figurine, Persian gulf seal, Double burial (male-female)
Kalibangan (*Black Bangles*)	Hanumangarh (Rajasthan)	**Ghaggar** (ancient Saraswati)	A. Ghosh (1953), B.B. Lal & B.K. Thapar	**Ploughed field surface** (furrows), Camel bones, Row of **7 fire altars**, Wooden drainage, Decorated floor tiles, Both citadel & lower town fortified
Chanhudaro	Sindh (Pakistan)	**Indus**	N.G. Majumdar (1931), Mackay (1935)	**Only site without a citadel**, Bead-making factory, Lipstick/cosmetics, Inkpot, Imprint of dog's paw chasing a cat
Dholavira	Kutch (Gujarat) - Khadir Bet	Luni basin (Mansar & Manhar streams)	J.P. Joshi (1967), R.S. Bisht (1990)	**Three-tier city division** (Citadel, Middle Town, Lower Town), Giant **water reservoirs/dams**, Unique **10-symbol signboard**, Sports stadium; **UNESCO WHS (2021)**
Banawali	Fatehabad (Haryana)	Saraswati / Rangoi	R.S. Bisht (1974)	**Terracotta toy model of plough**, High quantity of good quality barley, Lack of systematic grid drainage
Rakhigarhi	Hisar (Haryana)	Ghaggar-Hakra	Amarendra Nath	**Largest Harappan site in India** (and overall after recent surveys)
Ropar (Roopnagar)	Punjab (India)	**Sutlej**	Y.D. Sharma (1953)	**Dog buried with human oval pit** (post-Harappan continuation), First site excavated after independence
Surkotada	Kutch (Gujarat)	Seasonal stream	J.P. Joshi (1964)	**Horse bone remains** (disputed), Pot burials, Oval citadel
Daimabad	Ahmednagar (Maharashtra)	**Pravara** (Godavari tributary)	B.P. Bopardikar	**Southernmost IVC site**, Bronze chariot with driver, Rhino, Elephant, Buffalo
Alamgirpur	Meerut (Uttar Pradesh)	**Hindon** (Yamuna tributary)	Y.D. Sharma (1958)	**Easternmost IVC site** in India; cloth impression on pottery; triangle–peacock–squirrel motifs. **Not** Rakhigarhi (Haryana = largest, not east).
Hulas	**Saharanpur** (UP; some lists tag the Baghpat belt)	Upper Ganga–Yamuna doab	**K.N. Dikshit** (ASI)	Eastern Harappan habitation: handmade + wheel-made pottery, chert blades, bone points. **UPPCS match: Hulas = Uttar Pradesh** (not Gujarat).
Mandi	**Muzaffarnagar** (UP; some lists Bijnor / Ramganga)	Doab	ASI	Late Harappan **jewellery / gold-hoard** find. **Mandi (UP) ≠ Manda (J&K)**. With Hulas, the usual UP pair that rejects **Rakhigarhi**.
Sanauli	**Baghpat** (Uttar Pradesh)	Yamuna basin	D.V. Sharma / ASI (**2018**)	About **125** graves, coffins, copper antenna swords, solid wooden-wheel **chariots**. Late Harappan / OCP — **not** a Mature grid-city with a Great Bath. Same district belt as Hulas lists, different period label.
Bargaon / Ambakheri	**Saharanpur** (Uttar Pradesh)	Doab	ASI	Late Harappan / **OCP** belt of western UP (with Hastinapur, Lal Qila, Atranjikhera). Rural doab, not a citadel city.

SITE	LOCATION / STATE	RIVER	EXCAVATOR & YEAR	KEY UNIQUE FINDINGS / EXAM TRIGGERS
Manda	Jammu & Kashmir	**Chenab**	J.P. Joshi (1982)	**Northernmost IVC site** in India. Trap: **Manda ≠ Mandi**.
Sutkagen Dor	Balochistan (Pak-Iran border)	**Dasht**	Aurel Stein (1927)	**Westernmost IVC site**, Coastal trading post between Harappa & Babylon
Kunal	Haryana	Saraswati	J.S. Khatri	2 silver crowns discovered
Balu	Kaithal (**Haryana**)	-	-	Earliest evidence of garlic cultivation. Trap: **Balu ≠ UP**.
Padri	Bhavnagar belt (**Gujarat**)	Coastal Saurashtra	-	**Gujarat** match in the Balu–Manda–Padri–Hulas set. Trap: **Padri ≠ Hulas**.
Bhirrana	Fatehabad (**Haryana**)	Ghaggar	ASI / L.S. Rao	Often called among the **oldest** Harappan settlements. Not a UP site.

UP Harappan quartet: Alamgirpur (Meerut, east end) · **Hulas** (Saharanpur) · **Mandi** (Muzaffarnagar) · **Sanauli** (Baghpat, Late / OCP chariots). **Rakhigarhi is Haryana**, not UP.

UKPCS — no mature Indus city in Uttarakhand. Closest protohistoric belt: **Bahadrabad (Haridwar)** — OCP + Copper Hoards (Y.D. Sharma, 1951–53); **Bankot (Pithoragarh)** — 8 copper anthropomorphs (1989); **Malari (Chamoli)** — cist graves, 5.2 kg gold mask, Swat-style pottery. Do not list these as Harappa / Mohenjodaro-type cities.

2. Vedic Civilization — Literature, Philosophy & Geography

A. Rigvedic Rivers (Ancient vs Modern Name Match-up)

RIGVEDIC ANCIENT NAME	MODERN NAME	RIGVEDIC ANCIENT NAME	MODERN NAME
Vitasta	Jhelum	**Saraswati**	Ghaggar / Hakra (Most sacred: *Naditama*, *Devitama*)
Asikni	Chenab	**Drishadvati**	Chautang / Rakshi
Parushni	Ravi (Battle of 10 Kings on its bank)	**Kubha**	Kabul (Afghanistan)
Vipas	Beas	**Suvastu**	Swat (Afghanistan)
Sutudri	Sutlej	**Krumu**	Kurram (Afghanistan)
Sindhu	Indus (Most frequently mentioned river)	**Gomati**	Gomal (Afghanistan)
Sadaneera	Gandak (Mentioned in *Shatapatha Brahmana*)	**Marudvridha**	Maruwardwan (J&K)

B. Vedic Literature & Upanishadic Dialogues (Match Goldmine)

- **Rigveda**: 10 Mandalas, 1,028 Suktas (hymns); 3rd Mandala contains **Gayatri Mantra** (composed by Vishvamitra dedicated to solar deity Savitr); 7th Mandala describes **Dasrajan Yudha** (Battle of 10 Kings on Parushni/Ravi river won by Sudas of Bharata tribe); 9th Mandala dedicated entirely to **Soma**; 10th Mandala contains **Purusha Sukta** (first mention of 4 Varnas).
- **Samaveda**: Book of chants / melodies (*Ragas*); origin of Indian classical music; chanted by *Udgatri* priests.
- **Yajurveda**: Book of sacrificial prayers and rituals; divided into **Shukla Yajurveda** (White - poetry) and **Krishna Yajurveda** (Black - prose + verse).
- **Atharvaveda**: Charms, spells, magical formulas, everyday medicine; mentions *Sabha* and *Samiti* as twin daughters of Prajapati.
- **Key Brahmanas**:
- *Aitareya & Kaushitaki*: Rigveda.

- *Shatapatha Brahmana*: Largest and oldest Brahmana (attached to Shukla Yajurveda); story of Videgha Mathava carrying Agni across Sadaneera/Gandak.
- *Gopatha Brahmana*: Attached to Atharvaveda.
- **Famous Upanishadic Dialogues (Direct UPPSC/UKPSC Match-ups)**:
- **Mundaka Upanishad**: Sourced national motto **"Satyam Eva Jayate"** (*Truth Alone Triumphs*).
- **Katha Upanishad**: Famous philosophical dialogue between young boy **Nachiketa and Yama (God of Death)** on the nature of soul and immortality.
- **Brihadaranyaka Upanishad**: Largest Upanishad; contains celebrated philosophical debate between sage **Yajnavalkya and scholarly woman Gargi**; phrase "*Tamaso Ma Jyotirgamaya*".
- **Chhandogya Upanishad**: Contains story of **Satyakama Jabala** (boy who spoke truth about his parentage admitted by sage Gautama); dialogue between Uddalaka Aruni and son Svetaketu (*Tat Tvam Asi*).
- **Jabala Upanishad**: First explicit mention of the **Four Ashramas** (Brahmacharya, Grihastha, Vanaprastha, Sanyasa).

C. Six Vedangas (Limbs of the Vedas)

1. **Shiksha**: Phonetics and Pronunciation.
2. **Kalpa**: Ritual instructions (Shrauta Sutras, Grihya Sutras, Dharma Sutras, and **Sulba Sutras — ancient Indian Geometry & measurement!**).
3. **Vyakarana**: Grammar (Panini's *Ashtadhyayi*).
4. **Nirukta**: Etymology of Vedic words (Yaska's *Nirukta*).
5. **Chhanda**: Metrics and Poetic meters (Pingala's *Chhandasastra*).
6. **Jyotisha**: Astronomy and calculation of auspicious ritual calendar (Lagadha's *Vedanga Jyotisha*).

D. Six Schools of Indian Philosophy (Shad-Darshana)

SCHOOL OF PHILOSOPHY	FOUNDER / SAGE	FOUNDATIONAL TEXT	CORE PHILOSOPHICAL PRINCIPLE
1. Samkhya (*Oldest school*)	**Kapila Muni**	*Samkhya Sutra*	Dualistic realism: **Purusha** (Consciousness) and **Prakriti** (Matter); 25 basic elements
2. Yoga	**Patanjali**	*Yoga Sutra*	Eightfold path (**Ashtanga Yoga**: Yama, Niyama, Asana, Pranayama, Pratyahara, Dharana, Dhyana, Samadhi)
3. Nyaya	**Akshapada Gautama**	*Nyaya Sutra*	Logic, epistemology, and rigorous reasoning; 4 Pramanas (Pratyaksha, Anumana, Upamana, Shabda)
4. Vaisheshika	**Kanada (Uluka)**	*Vaisheshika Sutra*	**Atomic theory (Paramanu)**; universe composed of 9 physical substances; scientific classification
5. Purva Mimamsa	**Jaimini**	*Mimamsa Sutra*	Unquestioned authority of Vedas; ritualism, Dharma, and Vedic karma
6. Uttara Mimamsa (Vedanta)	**Badarayana (Vyasa)**	*Brahma Sutra*	Philosophy of Upanishads; Brahman is supreme reality; developed by Shankara (Advaita) & Ramanuja

E. Vedic Political Assemblies (Sabha, Samiti, Vidatha, Gana)

ASSEMBLY	COMPOSITION & NATURE	PRESIDING OFFICER	PRIMARY FUNCTIONS	WOMEN'S STATUS & RIGVEDIC VS LATER VEDIC EVOLUTION
Sabha (सभा)	Council of select **elders, nobles, and Brahmanas**; smaller and more elite body	**Sabhapati** / *Sabhapala*	**Judicial and advisory**: arbitrated disputes, dispensed justice, advised king on state affairs	Women attended in Early Vedic (*Sabhavati*); **strictly excluded in Later Vedic** as royal power and patriarchy grew
Samiti (समिति)	**General folk assembly of the entire tribe (*Vis*)**; broad democratic body	**Pati** or **Ishan**	**Political and electoral**: elected and re-elected the *Rajan* (King), debated peace/war, discussed national policy; Rigveda hymn (X.191) ends with prayer for common consensus	Women had **no role**; strictly male tribal gathering. In Later Vedic, kings gradually subdued Samiti's electing power
Vidatha (विदथ)	**Oldest tribal assembly** (mentioned 122 times in Rigveda vs 8 times for Sabha, 9 for Samiti)	Tribal elder / seer	**Ritual, redistributive, and military**: distributed war spoils/booty, conducted folk rituals, settled domestic customs	**Women actively participated** (*Vidathya*) and debated alongside men. **Completely disappeared in Later Vedic times**
Gana (गण)	Assembly of warrior clans / general troop gathering	**Ganapati** / *Jyeshtha*	Military deliberations and tribal defense	Minor folk council; evolved into post-Vedic oligarchic Gana-sanghas

> **Crucial Prelims Triggers:** - **Atharvaveda (7.12.1)** explicitly calls **Sabha and Samiti the twin daughters of Prajapati** (*Prajapateh duhitarau*). - **Judicial function** belonged exclusively to **Sabha** (not Samiti). - **Electoral function** (election of the King) belonged to **Samiti** (not Sabha). - **Earliest assembly: Vidatha** (Rigveda's highest mention count: 122).

F. High-Yield Vedic Terms & Vocabulary (Match & Meaning Goldmine)

Frequently tested in UPPCS & UKPCS Prelims:

ANCIENT VEDIC TERM	LITERAL MEANING / CONTEXT	HISTORICAL & EXAM SIGNIFICANCE
Aghanya (अघन्या)	"Not to be killed / slain"	Refers to the **Cow**; highest penalty (capital punishment or expulsion) for hurting/killing
Gavishti / Gaveshana / Goshu	"Search for cows"	**War / Battle**; cattle raids were the prime cause of inter-tribal conflicts in Rigvedic era
Gopati (गोपति)	"Protector of cattle"	Title of the **King / Tribal Chief** (*Rajan*)
Gomat (गोमत्)	"Possessor of cattle"	A **wealthy person** (wealth was measured in cattle heads, not coins/land)
Duhitri (दुहितृ)	"One who milks the cow"	**Daughter** in the family
Goghna (गोघ्न)	"One for whom a cow is offered"	A revered **Guest** visiting the household
Godhuli (गोधूलि)	"Dust raised by returning cattle"	Evening twilight / dusk (unit of time measurement)
Gavyuti (गव्यूति)	Cattle grazing radius	Unit of **distance measurement**
Kulapa (कुलप)	Head of the *Kula* (family)	Oldest male patriarch of the family
Gramani (ग्रामणी)	Leader of the *Grama* (village)	Head of village; led local militia and ranked among the 12 Ratnins
Vispati (विशपति)	Head of the *Vis* (clan / canton)	Clan chief between village (*Grama*) and tribe (*Jana*)
Vrajapati (व्राजपति)	Master of pastures	Officer in charge of pastures and cattle camps; led village warriors
Spasa (स्पश)	"Lookout / watcher"	**Spies / Intelligence agents** employed by the King/Varuna
Jivagribh (जीवगृभ्)	"One who seizes alive"	**Police official / arresting officer**
Duta (दूत)	Messenger	Royal envoy or ambassador
Yava (यव)	Food grain	**Barley** (the primary cereal of Rigvedic Aryans)
Godhuma (गोधूम)	Cereal grain	**Wheat** (widely cultivated in Later Vedic)
Vrihi (व्रीहि)	Cereal grain	**Rice** (extensively mentioned in Later Vedic texts)
Sira / Langala (सीर / लांगल)	Agricultural tool	**Plough**; *Sita* = furrow made by plough
Kinasha (कीनाश)	Field worker	**Ploughman / peasant cultivator**
Urvara / Kshetra (उर्वरा / क्षेत्र)	Land type	Fertile, cultivated agricultural field
Ayas (अयस्)	Metal	In Rigveda: **copper / bronze**; in Later Vedic: *Krishna-ayas / Shyama-ayas* = **iron**, *Lohita-ayas* = **copper**
Pani (पणि)	Trading folk	Wealthy non-Aryan traders/merchants; notorious in hymns as cattle-thieves
Bekhanata (बेखनाट)	Lender	**Usurer / Moneylender** who charged exorbitant interest rates
Nishka / Satamana (निष्क / शतमान)	Gold ornament / unit	In Rigveda: gold necklet/bullion; in Later Vedic: standardized gold unit of value

G. The 12 Vedic Ratnins (Jewel-Bearers of Royal Administration)

Mentioned in the Shatapatha Brahmana and Taittiriya Samhita during the Ratnahavimshi ceremony of the Rajasuya Yajna (King visits each official's home to offer oblation):

#	RATNIN (JEWEL-OFFICIAL)	EXACT DESIGNATION / OFFICIAL PORTFOLIO	KEY UPPCS EXAM TRAP
1	**Purohita** (पुरोहित)	Chief Royal Priest and chief political adviser to Rajan	Invariable first counselor of the realm
2	**Senani** (सेनानी)	Commander-in-Chief of the military forces	Leads the army in times of war
3	**Gramani** (ग्रामणी)	Village headman / leader of the rural militia	Represents rural folk in the royal circle
4	**Mahishi** (महिषी)	Chief Queen (first legally wedded queen)	Participated in royal consecration rites
5	**Suta** (सूत)	Charioteer, royal court minstrel, and herald	Chronicler of heroic royal deeds
6	**Sangrahitri** (संग्रहीतृ)	**Treasurer / Custodian of royal store**	Stores revenue and tribute
7	**Bhagadugha** (भागदुघ)	**Collector of the King's share (*Bhaga*) of revenue / taxes**	**UPPCS Trap:** Collects revenue (do NOT confuse with Akshavapa)
8	**Akshavapa** (अक्षावाप)	**Superintendent of gambling & royal dice accountant**	**UPPCS Trap (2023):** Dice/gambling officer, NOT revenue collector!
9	**Govikartana** (गोविकर्तन)	Keeper of forests, game master, companion in the royal hunt	Head of livestock and hunting preserves
10	**Palagala** (पालागल)	Royal courier, messenger, and confidential king's companion	Diplomatic emissary
11	**Kshattri** (क्षात्तृ)	Royal chamberlain / master of the royal household gate	Managed inner palace affairs
12	**Takshan / Rathakara** (तक्षन् / रथकार)	Chief carpenter and chariot-builder	Highest artisan status due to importance of chariots in war

3. 16 Mahajanapadas & Their Capitals (6th Century BCE)

MAHAJANAPADA	CAPITAL	MODERN LOCATION	HIGH-YIELD EXAM NOTES
Magadha	Girivraja / Rajagriha → Pataliputra	Patna & Gaya (Bihar)	Founded by Brihadratha; rose under Bimbisara (Haryanka)
Anga	**Champa** (ancient Malini)	Bhagalpur & Munger (Bihar)	Annexed by Bimbisara; major trade port to Suvarnabhumi
Kasi	**Varanasi**	Varanasi (UP)	Between Varuna and Asi rivers; famous for cotton textiles
Vatsa	**Kausambi**	Prayagraj/Kaushambi (UP)	King **Udayana** (hero of Bhasa's *Swapnavasavadattam*); Buddha visited
Kosala	**Sravasti** (North) / Saketa (South)	Ayodhya/Faizabad & Bahraich (UP)	King **Prasenjit** (contemporary of Buddha); Buddha spent most rainy seasons here
Saurasena	**Mathura**	Mathura (UP)	King Avantiputra (disciple of Buddha); Megasthenes mentions worship of Herakles (Krishna)
Panchala	**Ahichchhatra** (North, Bareilly) & **Kampilya** (South, Farrukhabad)	Rohilkhand & Central UP	Kannauj was part of it; transition from tribal to urban center
Kuru	**Indraprastha** (near Delhi) / Hastinapur	Meerut, Delhi, Thanesar	Shifted capital to Kaushambi after Hastinapur was flooded (Nichakshu)
Matsya	**Viratnagar** (Bairat, Jaipur)	Alwar, Bharatpur, Jaipur (Raj)	Hiding place of Pandavas; King Sujata
Chedi	**Suktimati** / Sotthivati	Bundelkhand (UP/MP)	King Shishupala (killed by Krishna in Mahabharata)
Avanti	**Ujjayini** (North) & **Mahishmati** (South)	Malwa / MP	King **Pradyota** (Mahasena); Jivaka (Bimbisara's physician) sent to treat his jaundice
Gandhara	**Taxila** (Takshashila) & Pushkalavati	Rawalpindi / Peshawar (Pak)	Famous university; King Pushkarasarin sent embassy to Bimbisara
Kamboja	**Rajpur** / Hataka	Rajouri & Hazara (NW frontier)	Famous for fine breed of horses; mentioned by Kautilya as *Varta-Shastropajivi*
Asmaka (Assaka)	**Potana** / Potali	Banks of river **Godavari** (Telangana/Maha)	**ONLY Mahajanapada situated south of the Vindhyas**
Vajji	**Vaishali**	Muzaffarpur / Vaishali (Bihar)	Confederacy of 8 clans (Lichchhavis, Videhas, Jnatrikas); First republican state
Malla	**Kushinagar** & **Pawa**	Deoria / Gorakhpur (UP)	Republican Gana-sangha; Buddha died at Kushinagar; Mahavira died at Pawa

UKPCS Special Note: Ashoka's Major Rock Edict in Uttarakhand is at **Kalsi** (Dehradun district) on the confluence of the Yamuna and Tons rivers.

4. Ashoka's 14 Major Rock Edicts (MRE) — Complete Cheat-Sheet

EDICT	CORE SUBJECT / MANDATE INSCRIBED
Major Rock Edict I	Prohibition of animal slaughter and festive gatherings (*Samaja*).
Major Rock Edict II	Medical treatment for men and animals in his empire and border lands; mentions **Cholas, Pandyas, Satiyaputras, Keralaputras, and Antiochus II Theos of Syria**.
Major Rock Edict III	Liberal attitude towards Brahmanas and Shramanas; ordering **Yuktas, Rajukas, and Pradeshikas** to go on tour of inspection every 5 years (*Anusamyana*).
Major Rock Edict IV	Sound of Dhamma-ghosha replaced the sound of Bheri-ghosha (war drum).
Major Rock Edict V	Appointment of **Dhamma Mahamattas** (in 14th regnal year) to propagate morality.
Major Rock Edict VI	King's accessibility: reporters (**Pativedakas**) ordered to report public matters to Ashoka at all times and places.
Major Rock Edict VII	Universal religious tolerance among all sects.
Major Rock Edict VIII	Replaced royal pleasure trips (*Viharayatras*) with religious tours (**Dhammayatras**); visited Bodh Gaya in 10th regnal year.
Major Rock Edict IX	Condemned meaningless rituals and ceremonies; extolled Dhamma-mangala.
Major Rock Edict X	Denounced individual fame and glory in favour of moral attainment.
Major Rock Edict XI	Declared that the gift of Dhamma (*Dhamma-dana*) is the highest of all gifts.
Major Rock Edict XII	Directive on mutual tolerance among all religious sects; appointment of *Ithijhakha Mahamattas* (female affairs officers).
Major Rock Edict XIII	**MOST IMPORTANT EDICT**: Records the **Kalinga War (261 BCE, 8th regnal year)**, deep remorse over 1,00,000 killed and 1,50,000 captured; victory by Dhamma declared supreme; **mentions 5 contemporary Greek Kings**: 1. **Antiochus II Theos** (Syria) 2. **Ptolemy II Philadelphus** (Egypt) 3. **Antigonus Gonatas** (Macedonia) 4. **Magas** (Cyrene) 5. **Alexander** (Epirus).
Major Rock Edict XIV	Summarizes the purpose and recording of the various rock inscriptions.

5. Buddhism & Jainism Quick-Recall Matrix

A. The 4 Buddhist Councils (Memorize the Pattern!)

COUNCIL	YEAR	VENUE	PATRON KING & DYNASTY	PRESIDENT / CHAIRMAN	LANDMARK ACCOMPLISHMENT
1st	**483 BCE**	Saptaparni Cave, **Rajagriha**	**Ajatashatru** (Haryanka)	**Mahakassapa**	**Sutta Pitaka** (Ananda - Buddha's teachings) & **Vinaya Pitaka** (Upali - Monastic rules) compiled
2nd	**383 BCE**	**Vaishali**	**Kalashoka** (Shishunaga)	**Sabakami**	First schism: Split into **Sthaviravadins** (Theravadins) and **Mahasanghikas**
3rd	**250 BCE**	**Pataliputra**	**Ashoka** (Maurya)	**Moggaliputta Tissa**	**Abhidhamma Pitaka** compiled (philosophical analysis); Kathavatthu added; Missionaries sent abroad
4th	**72 CE**	Kundalvana (**Kashmir**)	**Kanishka** (Kushana)	**Vasumitra** (President), **Ashvaghosha** (Vice-President)	Final split into **Hinayana** and **Mahayana**; *Mahavibhasha Shastra* written in Sanskrit

B. Buddha's 5 Great Life Events & Symbols

1. **Janma (Birth)**: Lotus and Bull (**563 BCE**, Lumbini, Kapilavastu).
2. **Mahabhinishkramana (Great Renunciation)**: Horse (Kanthaka).
3. **Nirvana / Sambodhi (Enlightenment)**: Bodhi Tree (Pipal / Ficus religiosa) at Bodh Gaya on Niranjana (Phalgu) river.
4. **Dharmachakrapravartana (First Sermon)**: Wheel / 8-Spoked Chakra (Deer Park at Sarnath / Rishipattana).
5. **Mahaparinirvana (Death)**: Stupa / Footprints (Sal tree grove at Kushinagar, **483 BCE**, age **80**).

C. Birth and death of Buddha and Mahavira

HEAD	GAUTAMA BUDDHA (SIDDHARTHA)	MAHAVIRA (VARDHAMANA)
Birth year	**563 BCE** (traditional; some books use a shorter chronology)	**599 BCE** (usual teaching set); some books use **540 BCE**
Birthplace	**Lumbini** (Nepal), near Kapilavastu of the **Shakya** clan	**Kundagrama** (Vaishali / Vajji belt, Bihar), **Jnatraka** clan
Parents	Father **Suddhodana**; mother **Mahamaya / Mayadevi** (Koliyan); raised by **Mahapajapati Gotami**	Father **Siddhartha**; mother **Trishala** (sister of Lichchhavi chief **Chetaka**)
Wife / child	**Yashodhara**; son **Rahul**	Jain tradition names wife **Yashoda** (a different person from Yashodhara)
Renunciation	Age **29** (*Mahabhinishkramana*; horse **Kanthaka**)	Age **30** (*grihatyaga*)
Awakening	Enlightenment at about **35**, **Bodh Gaya** (Vaishakha Purnima)	**Kevala jnana** at about **42**
Death year	**483 BCE** (*Mahaparinirvana*)	**527 BCE** (usual); some books use **468 BCE**
Death place	**Kushinagar** (UP, Malla republic), sala grove, age **80**	**Pavapuri / Pawa** (Bihar), age **72**
Proof of birthplace	Ashoka's **Rummindei** pillar at Lumbini	Kundagrama / Vaishali tradition; not marked by Rummindei

> **Logic:** Buddha **563–483 BCE**, 80 years. Mahavira **599–527 BCE**, 72 years. Do not swap Lumbini with Kundagrama, or Kushinagar with Pavapuri. **Nayaputta** is an epithet of **Mahavira**, not of Buddha. If a stem uses the shorter Jain pair **540–468 BCE**, both years still sit in the 6th–5th century BCE.

D. Jain Tirthankaras & Symbols (High-Frequency Match)

- **1st Rishabhanatha (Adinatha)**: **Bull** (Emblem) | Born in Ayodhya | Mentioned in Rigveda with Arishtanemi.
- **2nd Ajitanatha**: **Elephant** | Born in Ayodhya.

- **16th Shantinaatha**: **Deer**.
- **19th Mallinatha**: **Water Jar (Kalasha)** | Shvetambaras consider Mallinatha a female.
- **22nd Neminatha (Arishtanemi)**: **Conch (Shankha)** | Cousin of Krishna.
- **23rd Parshvanatha**: **Serpent / Hooded Cobra** | Born in Varanasi (Ashvasena's son); propounded 4 vows (*Chaturyama*).
- **24th Mahavira (Vardhamana)**: **Lion** | Born **599 BCE** at Kundagrama (Vaishali); died **527 BCE** at Pavapuri (age 72); added 5th vow: **Brahmacharya**.
- **Jain Councils**:
- **1st Council (c. 300 BCE)**: Pataliputra | Presided by **Sthulabhadra** | 12 Angas compiled | Split into Shvetambara (white-clad, led by Sthulabhadra) and Digambara (sky-clad, led by Bhadrabahu).
- **2nd Council (512 CE)**: Vallabhi (Gujarat) | Presided by **Devardhi Kshamasramana** | Final compilation of 12 Angas & 12 Upangas in Ardhamagadhi Prakrit.

6. Ancient Dynasties — From / To, Founder, Last Ruler, High-Yield

Magadha spine (do not skip a rung): **Haryanka** → **Shishunaga** → **Nanda** → **Maurya** → **Shunga** → **Kanva**.

DYNASTY	PERIOD (FROM–TO)	FOUNDER	LAST RULER	CAPITAL	KEY RULER & HIGH-YIELD
Haryanka	**c. 544–412 BCE**	**Bimbisara** (Shrenika; annexes **Anga**; contemporary of Buddha & Mahavira)	**Nagadasaka** (weak tail; minister Shishunaga takes the throne)	**Rajagriha / Girivraja**	**Ajatashatru** — *rathamusala*, war on Vajji, **1st Buddhist Council** (Rajagriha). **Udayin** first makes **Pataliputra** the Magadhan capital (Ajatashatru only seeds Pataligrama).
Shishunaga	**c. 412–344 BCE**	**Shishunaga** (ex-viceroy of Kashi)	**Nandivardhana / Mahanandin** (overthrown by Mahapadma Nanda)	Girivraja → **Vaishali** (second capital tradition)	Founder **takes Avanti / Malwa** (ends Pradyota). **Kalashoka / Kakavarna** — **2nd Buddhist Council** at Vaishali (schism). Did **not** found Pataliputra.
Nanda	**c. 344–321 BCE**	**Mahapadma Nanda** (*Ekarat*, *Sarvakshatrantaka*, *Ugrasena*, *Aparoparashurama*)	**Dhana Nanda** (Greek **Agrammes / Xandrames**; commander Bhaddasala)	**Pataliputra**	Nine Nandas. Huge standing army; **Alexander never fought** them (326 BCE is still Dhana Nanda's reign). Hathigumpha later recalls a Nanda canal and a Jina image from Kalinga. Overthrown by **Chandragupta + Chanakya**.
Maurya	**c. 321–185 BCE**	**Chandragupta Maurya** (Greek *Sandrokottos*; Chanakya / Kautilya; treaty with Seleucus **c. 303 BCE**)	**Brihadratha** (killed by general **Pushyamitra Shunga**, 185 BCE)	**Pataliputra** (Ganga–Son)	**Bindusara** (*Amitraghata*). **Ashoka**: accession c. 272, coronation **268–232**; **Kalinga War 261 BCE** (MRE XIII); **3rd Council** at Pataliputra. Ashoka's death **232 ≠** end of empire — house runs to **185**.
Shunga	**185–73 BCE**	**Pushyamitra Shunga** (coup at a military review)	**Devabhuti** (killed / ousted by Vasudeva Kanva)	Pataliputra & **Vidisha**	Two **ashvamedhas** (Ayodhya / Dhanadeva record). **Agnimitra** (अग्निमित्र) in Kalidasa's (कालिदास) *Malavikagnimitra* (मालविकाग्निमित्रम्). **Patanjali** (*Mahabhashya* (महाभाष्य)) is Shunga-age, not Kanishka's court. Sanchi still grows.
Kanva	**73–28 BCE**	**Vasudeva Kanva**	**Susarman**	Pataliputra	Short Magadha coda after Shungas. Deccan **Satavahanas** rise as this house fades.
Satavahana (Andhra)	**c. 230 BCE – 3rd c. CE**	**Simuka**	Last great often **Yajna Sri Satakarni** (later Pulomavi line)	**Pratishthana (Paithan)** & Amaravati	**Gautamiputra Satakarni** — *Ekabrahmana*, *Trisamudrapitapoyavahana* (Nasik cave of mother **Gautami Balashri**); smashed Western Kshatrapas. **Lead & potin** coins; matrilineal *Gautamiputra / Vasisthiputra* titles. **Hala** — Prakrit *Gatha Saptasati*. Yajna Sri — **ship** on coins.
Kushana	**1st–3rd c. CE**	**Kujula Kadphises** (Kadphises I)	Last great **Vasudeva I** (then fragmentation)	**Purushapura (Peshawar)** & **Mathura**	**Vima Kadphises** — first Kushana **gold** (*dinar*). **Kanishka** — **Shaka era 78 CE** (some books peak c. 127); **4th Council** at Kundalvana (Kashmir); Gandhara + Mathura art; titles *Devaputra*. Do not make Kanishka a Gupta.
Gupta	**c. 320–550 CE**	**Sri Gupta** → **Ghatotkacha** (both *Maharaja*); real imperial start **Chandragupta I** (**Maharajadhiraja**, Gupta era **319/320 CE**, queen **Kumaradevi**)	Last great **Skandagupta**; later line thins (e.g. Vishnugupta)	**Pataliputra** (CG II also uses **Ujjain**)	**Samudragupta** — Prayag Prashasti by **Harisena**; *Napoleon of India*; Aryavarta uprooted, Dakshinapatha captured-and-freed. **Chandragupta II Vikramaditya** — *Sakari*, ends Western Kshatrapas (Rudrasimha III); Mehrauli iron pillar; Fa-Hien. **Kumaragupta I** — Nalanda tradition. **Skandagupta** —

DYNASTY	PERIOD (FROM–TO)	FOUNDER	LAST RULER	CAPITAL	KEY RULER & HIGH-YIELD
					Bhitari (Ghazipur, UP) vs **Hunas**; repairs Sudarsana lake.
Vakataka	**c. 250–500 CE**	**Vindhyashakti**	**Harishena** (Vatsagulma branch; Ajanta later caves)	**Vatsagulma** (Washim) / Nandivardhana	**Pravarasena I** — four *ashvamedhas*. Gupta–Vakataka tie: **Prabhavatigupta** (daughter of CG II) married **Rudrasena II** and ruled as regent.
Maukhari	**6th c. CE** (till **c. 606**)	**Harivarman**	**Grahavarman**	**Kannauj** (Kanyakubja, UP)	Grahavarman married **Rajyashri** (Harsha's sister); killed by **Deva Gupta of Malwa** + **Shashanka** of Gauda — the spark for Harsha's rise.
Pushyabhuti (Vardhana)	House earlier; **Harsha 606–647 CE**	**Pushyabhuti** (house); effective reunion king **Harshavardhana**	**Harsha** (no stable heir after **647**; Wang Xuance / Arunashva)	Thanesar → **Kannauj**	**Harsha-samvat 606**. Xuanzang (*Si-Yu-Ki*). Kannauj & Prayag assemblies. Stopped on the **Narmada** by **Pulakeshin II**. Banabhatta — *Harshacharita*. Not a Gupta emperor.
Badami Chalukya	**543–753 CE**	**Pulakeshin I**	**Kirtivarman II** (overthrown by Rashtrakuta **Dantidurga**)	**Vatapi (Badami**, Karnataka)	**Pulakeshin II** — defeats Harsha on Narmada; **Aihole / Meguti** prashasti by Jain poet **Ravikirti** (रविकीर्ति) (names **Kalidasa** (कालिदास) & **Bharavi** (भारवि)). Clash with Pallavas (Narasimhavarman I sacks Vatapi — *Vatapikonda*).
Pallava of Kanchi	**c. 575–897 CE**	**Simhavishnu** (imperial line)	**Aparajita** (defeated by Chola **Aditya I**)	**Kanchipuram**	**Mahendravarman I** — *Mattavilasa Prahasana*; rock-cut start. **Narasimhavarman I Mahamalla** — defeats Pulakeshin II; **Mamallapuram** rathas / shore temple age.

Logic: Maurya **321–185**, not 321–232. Gupta **320–550**, not "ends with Chandragupta II." Harsha **606–647** is Pushyabhuti, not Gupta. Shunga **185** is the Mauryan end, not Kalinga (261).

7. Epigraphy & Inscriptions (The Match-the-Following Goldmine)

INSCRIPTION	PLACE / STATE	KING / DYNASTY	AUTHOR / KEY FACT
Prayag Prashasti (Allahabad Pillar)	Prayagraj (UP)	**Samudragupta** (Gupta)	Composed by court poet **Harisena** (हरिषेण) in *Champu* (चम्पू) (verse + prose) style in Sanskrit. Mentions *Digvijaya*, *Dakshinapatha* (12 kings - *Grahana-Mokshanugraha*), *Aryavarta* (9 kings exterminated). Also has inscriptions of Ashoka, Jahangir, Birbal!
Hathigumpha Inscription	Udayagiri hills, Bhubaneswar (Odisha)	**Kharavela** (Chedi/Mahameghavahana)	In Prakrit, Brahmi script. Mentions: canal dug by Nandaraja 300 yrs earlier brought to Kalinga, invasion of Magadha (*Bahisatimita* defeated), first epigraphic mention of **Bharatavarsha**.
Junagarh Rock Inscription	Girnar, Junagadh (Gujarat)	**Rudradaman I** (Western Kshatrapa, 150 CE)	**First chaste, elaborate Sanskrit inscription**. Records history of **Sudarshana Lake**: built under Chandragupta Maurya (Pushyagupta), canal added by Ashoka (Tushaspha), repaired by Rudradaman (Suvisakha) **without levying extra tax/Vishti**, later restored by Skandagupta (Chakrapalita)!
Aihole Inscription	Bagalkot (Karnataka)	**Pulakeshin II** (Badami Chalukya)	Composed by Jain poet **Ravikirti** (रविकीर्ति) at Meguti temple. Mentions Pulakeshin II defeating Harshavardhana on the banks of Narmada; mentions poets **Kalidasa** (कालिदास) and **Bharavi** (भारवि).
Mehrauli Iron Pillar	Qutb Complex, Delhi	**Chandra** (Chandragupta II Vikramaditya)	Rustless iron metallurgy; defeated Vanga confederacy and crossed 7 mouths of Sindhu to defeat Vahlikas. Dedicated to Lord Vishnu (*Vishnupada*).
Nasik Cave Inscription	Nasik (Maharashtra)	**Gautamiputra Satakarni** (Satavahana)	Issued by his mother **Gautami Balashri**. Titles: *Ekabrahmana*, *Kshatriya-darpa-man-mardana*, *Trisamudrapitapoyavahana* (whose horses drank water of three seas).
Besnagar (Vidisha) Pillar	Vidisha (Madhya Pradesh)	**Bhagabhadra** (Shunga)	Erected by **Heliodorus** (Greek ambassador of King Antialcidas of Taxila); calls himself *Bhagavata* and dedicates Garuda-dhvaja to *Devadeva Vasudeva*.
Eran Inscription (510 CE)	Sagar (Madhya Pradesh)	**Bhanugupta** (Gupta)	**First epigraphic / dated evidence of Sati**: Goparaja (general) died fighting Hunas; his wife immolated herself on his funeral pyre.
Uttiramerur Inscription	Kanchipuram (Tamil Nadu)	**Parantaka I** (Chola, 10th c.)	In-depth details of **Chola village self-government**, Kudavolai (pot-ticket lot) system, and committee qualification rules for *Variyam*.
Rummindei Pillar Inscription	Lumbini (Nepal)	**Ashoka** (Maurya)	Commemorates Ashoka's visit to Buddha's birthplace (20th regnal year). **Tax concessions**: Land revenue (*Bhaga*) reduced from 1/6th to **1/8th**, and religious tribute (*Bali*) completely abolished.
Bhabru (Bairat) Edict	Rajasthan	**Ashoka** (Maurya)	Ashoka explicitly affirms faith in the **Buddha, Dhamma, and Sangha**; calls himself *Piyadassi Raja Magadha*.
Maski, Gurjara, Nittur, Udegolam	Karnataka & MP	**Ashoka** (Maurya)	Inscriptions where the personal name **"Ashoka"** is explicitly written (instead of just *Devanampiya Piyadassi*).
Sohgaura (Gorakhpur) & Mahasthangarh (Bogura)	UP & Bangladesh	Maurya Period	Copper plate & limestone plaque mentioning **famine relief measures** and state granary maintenance.

8. Ancient Ports & Ancient Coins

A. Major Ancient Indian Ports (Direct Match Questions)

- **Western Coast**:
- **Bharuch / Barygaza** (Narmada estuary, Gujarat): Most active port for trade with Roman Empire.
- **Sopara (Surparaka)** (near Mumbai, Maharashtra): Ashokan edict site; major trade center.
- **Kalyan (Calliena)** (Thane, Maharashtra).
- **Muziris / Kodungallur** (Periyar river mouth, Kerala): Roman trade hub; exported black pepper (**"Yavanapriya"**); temple of Augustus built here.
- **Nelcynda & Tyndis** (Kerala coast).
- **Eastern Coast**:
- **Tamralipti / Tamluk** (Midnapore, West Bengal - Hooghly river): Premier port for trade with Southeast Asia, China, and Sri Lanka; Fa-Hien sailed back to China from here.
- **Arikamedu (Podouke)** (near Puducherry): Roman trading post; excavated by Mortimer Wheeler; Roman amphorae, Arretine ware, and Roman coins found.
- **Poompuhar / Kaveripattinam** (Kaveri mouth, Tamil Nadu): Capital port of the Early Cholas (celebrated in *Silappadikaram*).
- **Korkai** (Tamil Nadu): Famous pearl-fishery port of the Pandyas.

B. Ancient Coins & Currency Units

- **Nishka / Satamana**: Gold ornaments/weights in Vedic period; later evolved into currency terms.
- **Karshapana / Pana**: Standard **silver punch-marked coins** (bearing symbols of sun, tree, hill, peacock) in Mauryan and Mahajanapada era.
- **First Gold Coins in India**: Issued by **Indo-Greeks (2nd c. BCE)**; also first to issue coins with portraits and legends of kings.
- **Largest Number of Pure Gold Coins**: Issued by **Kushanas** (Vima Kadphises and Kanishka - *Dinar* based on Roman denarius weight standard).
- **Largest Quantity of Gold Coins**: Issued by **Guptas** (*Dinar* for gold; *Rupaka* for silver, started by Chandragupta II after defeating Shakas).
- **Lead and Potin Coins**: Distinctive currency issued by the **Satavahanas**.
- **Cowries (Kaudi)**: Common medium of exchange for daily petty transactions (recorded by Fa-Hien in Gupta era).

9. Ancient Indian Administrative Officers Master Matrix

A. Mauryan Central Administration (Arthashastra & Edicts)

- **Central Tirthas (18 Supreme Functionaries)**: Top cabinet-level officials including *Mantri* (Prime Minister), *Purohita* (Chief Priest), *Senapati* (Army Chief), *Yuvaraja* (Crown Prince), and the two supreme fiscal heads:
- **Samaharta (समाहर्ता)**: **Collector General of Revenue** — responsible for preparing the annual state budget, assessing revenues, and overseeing tax collection across the entire empire (rural, urban, mines, forests).
- **Sannidhata (सन्निधाता)**: **Chief Treasury Officer & Custodian of Royal Storehouses** (*Koshadhyaksha*) — responsible for the safe keeping of the state treasury, constructing granaries, treasuries, and warehouses.
- **Megasthenes' Administrative Officials in *Indica***:
- **Astynomoi (नगर अध्यक्ष)**: 30 city officials of Pataliputra divided into **6 boards of 5 members each**:
  1. *Board 1*: Industrial arts & crafts inspection.
  2. *Board 2*: Care and surveillance of foreign visitors.
  3. *Board 3*: Registration of vital statistics (births and deaths).
  4. *Board 4*: Trade, commerce, and regulation of markets.
  5. *Board 5*: Inspection of manufactured goods and distinguishing new from old.
  6. *Board 6*: Collection of the **10% sales tax** on goods sold (evasion was punishable by death).

- **Agronomoi (जिला / ग्रामीण अधिकारी)**: Rural and district officers in charge of land measurement, irrigation canals, agriculture, timber, mining, and road maintenance (installed milestones every 10 stadia).
- **Ashoka's Key Administrative Cadres**:
- **Rajuka (रज्जुक)**: District administrator in charge of land survey, revenue assessment, and judicial administration (Ashoka granted them full independence in judicial punishment).
- **Yukta (युक्त)**: Subordinate secretarial officer / district accountant assisting the Rajukas.
- **Pradeshika (प्रादेशिक)**: Head of provincial/divisional administration on regular five-year inspection tours (*Anusamyana*).
- **Dhamma Mahamatta (धम्म महामात्र)**: High-ranking moral officials instituted in Ashoka's 14th regnal year (Rock Edict V) to propagate Dhamma, prevent arbitrary imprisonment, and supervise religious harmony.

B. Kautilya's 20+ Key Adhyakshas (Department Superintendents)

ADHYAKSHA (SUPERINTENDENT)	DEPARTMENT / ADMINISTRATIVE PORTFOLIO	EXAM KEYWORD / FUNCTION
Sitadhyaksha (सीताध्यक्ष)	**Agriculture & Crown Lands**	Supervised state farms (*Sita* lands) and farming labour
Pautavadhyaksha (पौतवाध्यक्ष)	**Weights and Measures**	Standardized scales and measures across markets
Panyadhyaksha (पण्याध्यक्ष)	**Trade and Commerce**	Regulated supply, pricing, and distribution of state merchandise
Samsthadhyaksha (संस्थाध्यक्ष)	**Markets and Guilds**	Monitored markets, prevented cartelization and cheating
Sulkadhyaksha (शुल्काध्यक्ष)	**Tolls, Customs & Octroi**	Collected transit duties and import/export taxes
Rupadarshaka (रूपदर्शक)	**Currency & Coinage Inspector**	Examined purity of punch-marked silver coins (*Pana*)
Akshapataladhyaksha (अक्षपटलाध्यक्ष)	**Accountant General & Archives**	Maintained central accounts, ledgers, and state audit
Mudradhyaksha (मुद्राध्यक्ष)	**Passports & State Seals**	Issued identity tokens and regulated travel/emigration
Navadhyaksha (नावाध्यक्ष)	**Shipping, Ferries & Waterways**	Managed maritime trade, rivers, ports, and toll-ferries
Akaradhyaksha (आकराध्यक्ष)	**Mines and Metallurgy**	Controlled state monopoly over mineral extraction
Lohadhyaksha (लोहाध्यक्ष)	**Iron and Metal Manufacture**	Supervised manufacture of iron weapons and tools
Suradhyaksha (सुराध्यक्ष)	**Liquor and Excise**	Regulated state breweries and alcohol taverns
Sunadhyaksha (सूनाध्यक्ष)	**Slaughterhouses & Animal Care**	Prevented cruelty and controlled meat production
Ganikadhyaksha (गणिकाध्यक्ष)	**Courtesans & Entertainers**	Regulated public entertainers, dancers, and royal spies
Vivitadhyaksha (विवीताध्यक्ष)	**Pastures and Grazing Lands**	Managed grazing grounds, dug wells, maintained security
Kupyadhyaksha (कुप्याध्यक्ष)	**Forest Produce & Timber**	Managed state forests, timber, and wild elephant reserves
Koshadhyaksha (कोषाध्यक्ष)	**Imperial Treasury**	Subordinate to Sannidhata; guarded gold, gems, and bullion
Ayudhagaradhyaksha (आयुधागाराध्यक्ष)	**Armoury & Weapons Storage**	Manufactured and preserved arms and military gear
Hastyadhyaksha (हस्त्यध्यक्ष)	**War Elephant Force**	Training, feeding, and deploying royal elephant corps
Ashvadhyaksha (अश्वाध्यक्ष)	**Cavalry & Royal Stables**	Imported and maintained war horses

C. Gupta & Harsha Administrative Officers

OFFICER DESIGNATION	DYNASTY / PERIOD	PORTFOLIO / EXACT ROLE
Kumaramatya (कुमारमात्य)	Gupta	**Elite administrative cadre**; equivalent to modern IAS; served as provincial governors, ministers, generals
Mahabaladhikrita (महाबलाधिकृत)	Gupta & Harsha	**Commander-in-Chief** of the imperial army
Mahadandanayaka (महादंडनायक)	Gupta	**Chief Judicial & Police Magistrate** (Harisena held Kumaramatya, Sandhivigrahika, and Mahadandanayaka)
Sandhivigrahika (सांधिविग्रहिक)	Gupta (started under Samudragupta)	**Minister for Peace and War** (Foreign Minister)
Mahapratihara (महाप्रतिहार)	Gupta & Harsha	**Chief of Palace Guards** and Lord Chamberlain
Uparika (उपरिक)	Gupta & Harsha	**Provincial Governor**; head of a *Bhukti* (province)
Vishayapati (विषयपति)	Gupta	**Head of a District** (*Vishaya*); administered with 4-member city council (*Adhisthana-adhikarana*): 1. *Nagara-sreshthi* (Chief of guild/banker) 2. *Sarthavaha* (Caravan merchant chief) 3. *Prathama-kulika* (Chief artisan) 4. *Prathama-kayastha* (Chief scribe/writer)
Pustapala (पुस्तपाल)	Gupta	**Keeper of land records and revenue surveys**
Shaulkika (शौल्किक)	Gupta	Collector of toll and customs duties (*Shulka*)
Dandapasika / Chauroddharanika	Gupta	Police officer / investigator in charge of catching thieves and criminals
Bhandagaradhikarana	Harsha	Chief superintendent of the royal treasury and storehouse

D. Chola Local Administration & Committees (Uttiramerur Inscription)

- **Three Core Assemblies**:
- **Ur**: General assembly of common tax-paying villagers in non-Brahmana settlements.
- **Sabha / Mahasabha**: Assembly of learned Brahmanas in tax-free **Brahmadeya / Agrahara** villages.
- **Nagaram**: Council of merchants and traders in commercial towns.
- **Variyam (Executive Standing Committees of Sabha)**:
- **Samvatsara-variyam**: Annual executive governing committee.
- **Eri-variyam**: **Tank and irrigation committee** (supervised desilting and water sharing).
- **Totta-variyam**: Garden and orchard committee.
- **Pon-variyam**: Gold and treasury assessment committee.
- **Panchavara-variyam**: Standing committee for general supervision.
- **Kudavolai System (कुदवोलाई)**: Pot-ticket lot system where candidates' names on palm leaves were drawn from an earthen pot by a young boy to ensure impartial committee selection.

10. Ancient Indian Taxes & Fiscal Terms Master Matrix

TAX / FISCAL TERM	PERIOD / CIVILIZATION	NATURE OF LEVY / SOURCE OF COLLECTION	HIGH-YIELD EXAM LOCK
Bali (बलि)	Vedic → Maurya	Vedic: Voluntary offering to Rajan in Rigveda → **Compulsory tax** in Later Vedic. Maurya: Religious tribute / additional land cess (Ashoka abolished Bali at Lumbini).	Voluntary in Rigveda; compulsory later
Bhaga (भाग)	Vedic → Maurya → Gupta	**King's royal share of agricultural produce**, traditionally fixed at **1/6th (*Shadbhaga*)**. Reduced to 1/8th by Ashoka at Lumbini.	Standard 1/6th land revenue
Sita (सीता)	Mauryan	**Revenue from crown agricultural lands** managed directly by the *Sitadhyaksha*.	Crown land revenue (distinct from Bhaga)
Kara (कर)	Mauryan & Gupta	Periodical tax levied on property, or specific tax levied on fruit, flower, and vegetable orchards.	Specific / periodic property tax
Vishti (विष्टि)	Maurya & Gupta	**Forced, unpaid labor** demanded by the state from artisans and peasants for public works.	Unpaid forced labor; treated as state income in Junagarh
Pranaya (प्रणय)	Mauryan	**Emergency war tax / gift of affection** levied during acute financial crisis (demanded 1/3 to 1/4 of produce).	Emergency fiscal levy
Vartani (वर्तनी)	Mauryan	**Transit duty / road cess** collected on goods by frontier officers (*Antapala*).	Transit duty / toll
Shulka (शुल्क)	Vedic → Gupta	**Customs duty, octroi, and toll taxes** levied on merchandise entering ports or market towns.	Toll / customs tax
Udakabhaga (उदकभाग)	Mauryan	**Water tax / irrigation cess** levied on farmers using state-constructed canals/lakes (varying from 1/5th to 1/3rd).	Irrigation / water cess
Hiranya (हिरण्य)	Maurya & Gupta	**Tax paid in cash / gold** (as opposed to payment in agricultural kind).	Cash tax (gold/coins)
Pindakara (पिण्डकर)	Mauryan	Lump-sum tax assessed collectively on an entire village community.	Collective village tax
Bhoga (भोग)	Gupta	**Daily customary tribute** of fruits, flowers, vegetables, and firewood offered by villagers to the king.	Daily tribute in kind (fruit/firewood)
Udranga (उद्रंग)	Gupta	Land revenue tax levied on **permanent tenants / water tax**.	Tax on permanent cultivators
Uparikara (उपरिकर)	Gupta	Additional tax levied on **temporary cultivators / non-permanent tenants**.	Tax on temporary tenants
Halikakara (हलिककर)	Gupta	**Plough tax** levied per plough owned by the peasant.	Tax per plough
Kadamai / Kudimai	Chola	**Primary land revenue** payable in paddy or cash to the king.	Main Chola land revenue
Vetti / Vetti-muttavalu	Chola	**Unpaid communal forced labor** for public tanks, temples, and palaces.	Chola forced labor (equivalent to Vishti)
Amanji	South India	Gratuitous labor or personal service to royal officials.	Personal royal service
Iraiyili (इरैयिली)	Chola / South India	**Tax-free land grant** bestowed upon temples (*Devadana*) or Brahmanas (*Brahmadeya*).	Tax-exempt land
Karai (करै)	Sangam	Land tax levied on agricultural produce by Tamil kings.	Sangam land tax
Ulgu / Sungam	Sangam & Chola	Customs duties, transit fees, and octroi tolls on trade caravans.	Toll / customs
Iravu (इरवु)	Sangam	Extra forced contribution or emergency demand made by the king.	Forced emergency demand

11. Ancient Land Classifications, Social Systems & Sangam Eco-Zones

A. 5 Types of Land in Ancient India (Gupta Inscriptions & Amarakosha)

1. **Kshetra (क्षेत्र)**: Land fit for **cultivation and agriculture**.
2. **Khila (खिल)**: **Waste, fallow, or uncultivated land**.
3. **Aprahata (अप्रहत)**: **Virgin, uncultivated jungle / forest land**.
4. **Vasti (वास्तु)**: **Habitable land** suitable for building homesteads and residential houses.
5. **Gapata-Sarah (गपत-सरह)**: **Pasture land** reserved for grazing cattle.

> **Ancient Land Tenure Systems:** - **Nivi-dharma (नीवी धर्म)**: Perpetual land endowment where the recipient enjoys income in perpetuity without right to sell or transfer ownership. - **Aprada-dharma (अप्रदा धर्म)**: Grantee can enjoy the revenue but has zero right to alienate or destroy property. - **Bhumi-chhidra-nyaya (भूमि-छिद्र-न्याय)**: Customary right of first clearance: anyone who clears virgin/waste land acquires ownership rights over it.

B. The 8 Types of Hindu Marriage (Manusmriti)

- **Approved / Dharmya Marriages (Prashasta — 4 Types)**: 1. **Brahma**: Father gifts decorated daughter to a learned, virtuous groom without demanding dowry (Highest & purest form). 2. **Daiva**: Father gives daughter to an officiating priest during a formal Vedic sacrifice. 3. **Arsha**: Groom offers a pair of cows and a bull to the bride's father to fulfill religious duties (not as bride-price). 4. **Prajapatya**: Father gifts daughter with blessing: "*May both of you perform your religious duties together*".
- **Unapproved / Adharmya Marriages (Aprashasta — 4 Types)**: 5. **Asura**: Groom buys the bride by paying money/wealth to her father and relatives (Bride-price marriage). 6. **Gandharva**: Love marriage based on mutual passion between bride and groom without parents' consent (e.g., Dushyanta & Shakuntala). 7. **Rakshasa**: Forcible abduction and marriage of a crying maiden after fighting and slaying her kinsmen. 8. **Paishacha**: Ravishing a maiden while she is asleep, intoxicated, or mentally deranged (Lowest and most sinful form).

> **Varna Marriage Rules:** - **Anuloma (अनुलोम)**: Marriage of a higher varna male with a lower varna female (Permitted by Dharma texts). - **Pratiloma (प्रतिलोम)**: Marriage of a lower varna male with a higher varna female (Severely condemned; produced untouchables/Chandalas).

C. Sangam Five Landscapes (Ainthinai / 5 Tinai)

Each Tinai represents an ecological zone, characteristic deity, and primary livelihood:

TINAI (LANDSCAPE)	ECO-ZONE / TOPOGRAPHY	PRESIDING DEITY	PRIMARY LIVELIHOOD / OCCUPATION
Kurinji (कुरिंजी)	**Hilly / Mountainous**	**Murugan** (Seyon - God of War)	Hunting, honey-gathering, shifting cultivation
Mullai (मुल्लै)	**Forest / Pastoral Grasslands**	**Mayon** (Vishnu / Krishna)	Cattle-rearing, pastoralism, dairy farming
Marudam (मरुदम)	**Fertile Agricultural Plains**	**Vendan** (Indra - God of Rain)	Wet-paddy agriculture, farming
Neydal (नेयदाल)	**Coastal / Littoral Belt**	**Varunan** (God of the Sea)	Fishing, boat building, salt manufacturing
Palai (पालै)	**Arid / Desert / Parched Land**	**Korravai** (Goddess of Victory/War)	Highway robbery, raiding, military plunder

Chapter 02: Chronology — Year-Wise Major Events (Ancient India)

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Alexander 326–325 BCE** (Hydaspes vs Porus; mutiny at Beas) → **Chandragupta Maurya c. 321 BCE**.
2. **Kalinga War c. 261 BCE** — Ashoka's turning point to Dhamma; **Third Council c. 250 BCE** at Pataliputra.
3. **Harsha 606–647 CE**; defeated on the Narmada by **Pulakeshin II** (Aihole / Ravikirti).
4. **Chandragupta Maurya = Chandragupta I** → different dynasties.
5. **Fa-Hien = Harsha** → Fa-Hien is Gupta-age; Xuanzang is Harsha-age.
6. **Alexander after Chandragupta** → Alexander **before** Mauryan foundation.
7. **Kanishka = Gupta** → Kushana, not Gupta.
8. **First Buddhist Council under Ashoka** → First is Rajagriha; Ashoka linked to the Third.
9. **Saka Era = 57 BCE** → **78 CE**; Vikrama is **57 BCE**.
10. **Kalinga War = 185 BCE** → **c. 261 BCE**; 185 is Mauryan end.

Chapter 03: Stone Age (Prehistoric India)

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Hathnora** on the Narmada in Madhya Pradesh yielded a ***Homo erectus*** skull, found by **Arun Sonakia** in **1982**. It is not a modern *Homo sapiens* fossil.
2. **Attirampakkam** in the Kortallayar valley of Tamil Nadu has Acheulian tools about **1.5 million years** old. It is a **tool** site, not a hominin fossil site.
3. **Robert Bruce Foote** recognised the first Indian Paleolithic tools at **Pallavaram** (Tamil Nadu) in **1863**. He is called the Father of Indian Prehistory.
4. **Bagor** on the Kothari in Rajasthan is the Mesolithic **animal-domestication** key. **V.N. Misra** excavated it. It is not a Paleolithic shrine.
5. **Sarai Nahar Rai** (सराय नाहर राय), **Mahadaha**, and **Damdama** in Pratapgarh, Uttar Pradesh, are Mesolithic **burial** sites of the Ganga plain. Domestication is Bagor; burials are Pratapgarh.
6. **Non-geometric** microliths (backed blades) belong to the earlier Mesolithic. **Geometric** microliths (lunates, triangles, trapezes) belong to the later Mesolithic.
7. **Mehrgarh** (मेहरगढ़) in Balochistan is the earliest farming village of the subcontinent, around **7000 BCE**. First crops are **wheat and barley**. Period I is **aceramic** (farming without pottery).
8. **Koldihwa** and **Mahagara** in the Belan valley of Mirzapur–Prayagraj, Uttar Pradesh, are the early **rice** pair. **G.R. Sharma** excavated them.
9. **Mahagara** alone has the **cattle pen with hoof marks**. **Koldihwa** is known for **rice-husk impressions** in pottery. Keep the two sister facts separate.
10. **Lahuradewa** in **Sant Kabir Nagar**, Uttar Pradesh, has early Ganga-plain **rice** at a lake edge. It is **not** a Belan valley site.
11. **Burzahom** (बुरज़होम) near Srinagar has Neolithic **pit dwellings** about 2–4 m deep and a famous **dog burial**. **Gufkral** in Pulwama means "cave of the potter."
12. **Chirand** in Saran, Bihar, is the Gangetic Neolithic site famous for **bone and antler tools**. It has no Burzahom-style pit dwellings and no South Indian ash mounds.
13. **Bhimbetka** (भीमबेटका) in Raisen, Madhya Pradesh, was first recognised by **V.S. Wakankar** in **1957–58**. UNESCO listed it in **2003**. There are about **750+** shelters and **500+** painted ones.
14. **Baghor** in the Son valley of Madhya Pradesh is an Upper Paleolithic stone **shrine**. **Bagor** in Rajasthan is Mesolithic **domestication**. Never swap the spellings.
15. **Inamgaon** in Maharashtra is the **Jorwe** type site. **Navdatoli** on the Narmada in Madhya Pradesh is **Malwa** culture, excavated by **H.D. Sankalia**.
16. **OCP** (Ochre Coloured Pottery) belongs to the western UP–Haryana–Rajasthan **doab**. **Hastinapur** (हस्तिनापुर) is a classic OCP site. It is not mature Harappan urban ware.
17. **Megaliths** are mainly **Iron Age** burial monuments of the Deccan and south (dolmens, cists, stone circles). They are not Stone Age Chalcolithic villages. Classic names include **Brahmagiri**, **Adichanallur**, **Maski** (मास्की), and **Hallur**.
18. **V. Gordon Childe** coined the phrase **Neolithic Revolution** for the shift from food collection to food production. The change in South Asia was staggered by region, not one national year.
19. **H.D. Sankalia** excavated **Langhnaj** (Gujarat Mesolithic) and **Navdatoli**. He did **not** discover Bhimbetka. **Madho Swaroop Vats** is a Harappan archaeologist and a Bhimbetka distractor.
20. **Chopani Mando** in the Belan valley of Uttar Pradesh shows Paleolithic–Mesolithic–Neolithic **continuity** and wild-rice gathering before full Belan farming.
21. **Prehistoric** = no writing. **Proto-historic** = undeciphered script (Indus / Copper Age). **Historic** North India is often dated from about the **6th century BCE**.
22. **Damdama** has a **triple** burial; **Sarai Nahar Rai** has a **four-skeleton** grave. Bone implements cluster at **Mahadaha** and **Sarai Nahar Rai**.
23. **Lahuradewa** (Sant Kabir Nagar) is the booklet key for earliest subcontinental **agriculture / rice** when listed; otherwise **Mehrgarh** is the wheat–barley settled-life key.

24. **OCP** was christened by **B.B. Lal** at **Hastinapur**. **Jorwe** adults lie **north–south** under house floors; children often rest in **double urns**.
25. **Ganeshwar–Jodhpura** in Rajasthan is a copper-working culture that supplied metal toward the Harappan zone. **Balathal** shows an early fortification-like wall in the Ahar belt.
26. **Patne** in Maharashtra is Upper Paleolithic and is known for **ostrich eggshell** beads. **Kurnool caves** (Andhra Pradesh) yield Upper Paleolithic **bone** tools.
27. **Hunsgi** and **Isampur** in Karnataka are Acheulian factory / quarry sites. **Gudiyam** in Tamil Nadu is a Paleolithic rock-shelter / cave site.
28. **Ahar–Banas** (Mewar, Rajasthan, about **2100–1500 BCE**) is **contemporary with the Harappan** civilisation, knew **rice**, and used white-painted **black-and-red ware**. The stem “rice was unknown to them” is false.
29. **Adamgarh** near Hoshangabad, Madhya Pradesh, shows a Paleolithic-to-Mesolithic sequence on the Narmada and early domestication claims. **Sivapithecus** Siwalik fossils are **not** *Homo* evidence against Hathnora.
30. **Hathnora** (Narmada Man) lies in the **Narmada valley of Madhya Pradesh**.
31. **Arun Sonakia** of the GSI discovered it in **1982**.
32. **Attirampakkam** lies in the **Kortallayar valley of Tamil Nadu**, near Chennai.
33. **Shanti Pappu’s** team dated the tools.
34. **Pallavaram** is in the Chennai belt of Tamil Nadu.
35. **Robert Bruce Foote** recognised Paleolithic tools there in **1863**.

Chapter 04: Indus Valley Civilization (Harappan Civilization)

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **2021:** Dholavira → UNESCO World Heritage Site.
2. **2018:** Sanauli chariot burials (ASI).
3. **2026:** Rakhigarhi skeletons to AnSI (Kolkata) and BSIP Lucknow for DNA / facial reconstruction; ASI 3-year excavation.
4. **Budget 2026:** 15 archaeological sites as experiential destinations, including **Lothal** and **Rakhigarhi** (राखीगढ़ी).
5. **Charles Masson** noticed Harappa ruins in **1826**. **Daya Ram Sahni** excavated Harappa in **1921**. **R.D. Banerji** excavated Mohenjo-daro in **1922**. **John Marshall** announced the civilization in **1924**.
6. **Alamgirpur** marks the **eastern boundary** of Harappan culture. Do not give that role to Rakhigarhi or Manda.
7. **Sanauli / Sinauli** (सनौली) in Baghpat, Uttar Pradesh (ASI, D.V. Sharma & S.K. Manjul, **2018**), is a Late Harappan / Copper Hoard necropolis with **wooden-wheel chariots**, copper-antenna swords, and coffined burials (~2000–1800 BCE). It is **not** a Mature grid-city with a Great Bath.
8. **Dholavira** (धोलावीरा) in Gujarat is known for water reservoirs, a **three-part** town plan (citadel, middle town, lower town), and a large **signboard**. UNESCO listed it in **2021**.
9. **Kalibangan** (कालीबंगा) in Rajasthan shows a **ploughed field** and **fire altars**. Its drainage is weaker than Mohenjo-daro's.
10. **Chanhudaro** (चन्हूदड़ो) is a craft town famous for **bead-making** and has **no citadel**.
11. **Rakhigarhi** in Hisar is the **largest Harappan site in India**. Size does not make it the eastern boundary.
12. **Surkotada** in Gujarat is often cited for **horse** bone claims. Treat the claim carefully; it is not a pan-Harappan horse culture.
13. **Banawali** in Haryana shows Early and Mature levels and a plough-mark tradition similar in spirit to Kalibangan.
14. **OCP** (Ochre Coloured Pottery) of the western UP doab overlaps Late Harappan decline and comes **before PGW**. It is rural ochre-wash pottery, not mature urban Harappan ware.
15. **Mandi** (Muzaffarnagar, UP) must not be confused with **Manda** (Jammu, northernmost site).
16. **Lothal** is the dockyard fact. **Dholavira** is the reservoir-and-signboard fact. Do not swap those identities.
17. **Mortimer Wheeler** improved excavation method at Harappa but did **not** discover the civilization. Discovery credit stays with Sahni, Banerji, and Marshall's announcement.
18. **B.B. Lal** excavated **Kalibangan** and later Hastinapur OCP levels. **R.S. Bisht** excavated **Dholavira** and Banawali.
19. **Cemetery R-37** = Harappa Mature coffin cemetery; **Cemetery H** = Late Harappan urn / fractional burial at Harappa. **Dockyard** = Lothal; **ploughed field** = Kalibangan; **Dancing Girl** = Mohenjo-daro.
20. **Early Harappan** builds regional cultures and fortifications before full urban grids; **Mature** is the peak of citadel–lower-town planning; **Late** is de-urbanisation and regional successors including doab OCP overlap.
21. **Daimabad** (Maharashtra) is the southernmost Harappan / Late Harappan site and yielded famous **bronze** figurines (chariot, buffalo, elephant, rhino). Those bronzes are **not** the same as Sanauli's wooden chariot burials.
22. **Chanhudaro** = bead craft town, **no citadel**. **Harappa** = granaries and Cemetery R-37. **Mohenjo-daro** = Great Bath and Dancing Girl. Keep site signatures separate.
23. **Mandi** (Muzaffarnagar jewellery / treasure find) and **Hulas** (Saharanpur) are the usual UP Harappan pair in stems. **Sanauli** is Baghpat Late Harappan / OCP — add it only when chariots or coffins are asked.
24. **Early Harappan** (~3300–2600 BCE): regional cultures (Kot Diji, Amri, Hakra, Sothi). Pre-urban, pottery, mud-brick.
25. **Mature Harappan** (~2600–1900 BCE): planned cities, seals, weights, long-distance trade. This is what papers mean by "IVC."
26. **Late Harappan** (~1900–1300 BCE) is the de-urbanisation phase.
27. **OCP** overlap appears in the doab in this late band.
28. **West:** Sutkagen-dor (Makran / Dasht coast).
29. **East:** Alamgirpur (Meerut, UP) on the **Hindon**.
30. **North:** Manda (Jammu, on the Chenab).
31. **South:** Daimabad (Maharashtra) on the **Pravara**.

32. **Stuart Piggott** called Harappa and Mohenjo-daro the **"twin capitals"** of an extensive kingdom — a useful phrase, not a proven dual capital constitution.
33. **Flood** decline readings are linked with Marshall, Mackay, and S.R. Rao.
34. **Aryan attack** readings by Childe, Wheeler, and Piggott are now **rejected** as a massacre model.
35. **Climate** decline readings are linked with Aurel Stein and Amalananda Ghosh.

Chapter 05: Vedic Civilization

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Sabha** (सभा) was an assembly of elders or nobles. **Samiti** (समिति) was the wider tribal assembly that could **choose the rajan** (राजन).
2. **Vidatha** (विदथ / विधाता) is the **oldest** gathering, with economic and ritual roles and women's presence. It **fades first** in Later Vedic times.
3. **Bhagadugha** (भागदुघ) collected the king's share (**bhaga** (भाग)). **Sangrahitri** (संग्रहीतृ) was the **treasurer**. **Akshavapa** (अक्षावाप) handled **dice / gambling**. Do not swap revenue with dice.
4. **Shukla (White) Yajurveda** is the **Vajasaneyi** (वाजसनेयी) school, with mantra and prose kept separate. **Krishna** (कृष्ण) here means **Black Yajurveda**, not the god Krishna.
5. **Aranyakas** (आरण्यक) are forest texts of symbolic ritual. **Upanishads** (उपनिषद्) teach **Brahman–Atman** philosophy (Vedanta).
6. **Varna** (वर्ण) is the four-fold order (Purusha Sukta; more rigid later). **Jati** (जाति) is later birth-group identity. Do not treat them as identical.
7. **Gavishti** (गविष्टि) means cattle-raid or war for cows. **Bali** (बलि) is tribute to the king. **Nishka** (निष्क) is a gold ornament or value-unit, **not** coined money.
8. **Shruti** (श्रुति) is "heard" Vedic revelation. **Smriti** (स्मृति) is remembered later dharma literature.
9. **PGW** (Painted Grey Ware), about **1100–600 BCE**, is the Later Vedic **doab** (दोआब) marker: grey pottery with black geometric paint.
10. **OCP** is pre-PGW ochre-wash doab rural pottery. **PGW** is iron-age painted grey ware of Later Vedic settlements.
11. **Brahmana** texts are ritual prose, not the same as the **Brahmana** varna. Context decides which meaning is asked.
12. **Videha** (north Bihar, Janaka tradition) is east of the UP doab but linked in Later Vedic texts such as the Shatapatha Brahmana.
13. **Arya** in classical Sanskrit means a **noble** person. Homeland theories include Tilak's **Arctic** (*The Arctic Home in the Vedas*), Max Müller's **Central Asia**, and others — none is a closed scientific proof.
14. **Sindhu** is named most often in the Rigveda; **Saraswati** is the most sacred (*Naditama / Devitama / Matetama* / नदीतमा, देवितमा, मातेतमा). Afghanistan rivers in the hymns include **Kubha, Krumu, Gomati, Suvastu**.
15. **Gayatri** (RV III.62.10, Vishvamitra → Savitr); **Satyameva Jayate** (*Mundaka*); **Tamaso mā jyotir gamaya** (*Brihadaranyaka*); Nachiketa–Yama (*Katha*).
16. **Boghaz-köi** (Hittite / Asia Minor) names **Indra, Varuna, Mitra, Nasatya**. Cow is **aghanya** (अघन्या - not to be killed). **Dasharajna** (दशराज्ञ युद्ध) was fought on the **Parushni** (परुष्णी / रावी).
17. **Sama Veda** is chant / melody drawn largely from Rigvedic verses. **Yajurveda** is the ritual-formula Veda (White / Black schools). **Atharvaveda** is charms and household rites.
18. **Aitareya** and **Shatapatha** are key **Brahmana** texts. **Brihadaranyaka** and **Chandogya** are major early **Upanishads**. **Mundaka** gives *Satyameva Jayate*.
19. **Panini** is the usual Vyakarana name. Do not swap him with Yaska.
20. **Veda** (वेद) means knowledge. The post-Harappan textual culture of the Indo-Aryans is called the **Vedic** age.
21. **Arya** in classical Sanskrit means a **noble** person. Older booklet keys sometimes call it a "superior race"; standard teaching treats Arya as a **cultural–linguistic** self-designation, not a modern racial science label.
22. **Bal Gangadhar Tilak** (बाल गंगाधर तिलक) argued the **Arctic / North Pole** in *The Arctic Home in the Vedas*; historians generally reject it.
23. **Max Müller** stressed **Central Asia** (most widely accepted view).
24. **Swami Dayanand Saraswati** argued **Tibet** (*Satyarth Prakash*).
25. **Boghazkoi Inscription** (Asia Minor / Turkey, 1400 BC) mentions 4 Rigvedic deities: **Indra, Varuna, Mitra, and Nasatyas**, confirming antiquity and Indo-Iranian linguistic links.
26. **Sindhu** is mentioned **most often** and is called **Hiranyayi**; it empties toward the Arabian Sea.
27. **Saraswati** is the **most sacred** river — *Matetama*, *Devitama*, *Naditama*.
28. **Yamuna** (यमुना) appears a few times; **Ganga** (गंगा) appears once in early Rigvedic memory.

29. **Sadaneera** is identified with the **Gandak** (गंडक); **Drishadvati** with the Ghaggar belt in many notes.
30. **Later Vedic** culture shifts **east** into the **Ganga–Yamuna doab** of western–central UP.
31. **Ayas** in the Rigveda means copper or bronze, not iron.
32. **Cattle are wealth.**
33. **Battle of Ten Kings (Dasrajan War):** Fought on the banks of river **Parushni (Ravi)**. King **Sudas** of the Bharata clan (Tritsu family, assisted by sage **Vasishtha**) defeated an alliance of 10 kings (5 Aryan + 5 non-Aryan) led by sage **Vishvamitra**.
34. **Rigvedic Rivers (Nadisukta):** Kubha (Kabul), Vitasta (Jhelum), Asikni (Chenab), Parushni (Ravi), Vipas (Beas), Sutudri (Sutlej), Drishadvati (Ghaggar), Sadanira (Gandak), Gomati (Gomal), Suvastu (Swat).
35. **Dasas** and **Dasyus** are rival groups in the hymns.

Chapter 06: Religious Movements

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Shramana** (श्रमण) renouncer traditions (often **nastika** (नास्तिक) / नास्तिक - non-Vedic) include Buddhism, Jainism, Ajivika, and Charvaka. **Astika** (आस्तिक) schools accept the authority of the Veda.
2. **Sarvastivada** (सर्वास्तिवाद) teaches *sarvam asti*, uses **Sanskrit**, and is tied to the Fourth Council at **Kundalvana**. **Vaibhasika (Vaibhashika)** (वैभाषिक) trusts Abhidharma; **Sautrantika** (सौत्रांतिक) trusts sutra only.
3. **Hinayana** (हीनयान) aims at the **arhat** (अर्हत्) and uses Pali. **Mahayana** (महायान) elevates the **bodhisattva** (बोधिसत्व) ideal and uses Sanskrit. **Vajrayana** (वज्रयान) adds tantra and mantra (Padmasambhava toward Tibet).
4. **Barabar** caves were gifted to **Ajivikas** (आजीविक), not to Buddhists. **Ajanta** (अजंता) is later Buddhist painted cave architecture.
5. **Chaitya** (चैत्य) is a prayer hall. **Vihara** (विहार) is a monastery. Keep the architectural pair straight.
6. **Rishabhanatha** (ऋषभदेव / आदिनाथ) has an **Ayodhya** birth tradition. **Bahubali / Gomateshwara** (बाहुबली / गोमटेश्वर) is famous but is **not** one of the 24 tirthankaras.
7. **Digambara** (दिगम्बर) monks are sky-clad and deny women's moksha as women. **Svetambara** (श्वेताम्बर) monks wear white and allow women's liberation. **Tattvartha Sutra** is accepted by both.
8. **Ajivika** (आजीवक) doctrine centres on **Makkhali Gosala** (मक्खलि गोशाल) and fatalist **niyati** (नियतिवाद). **Charvaka / Lokayata** (चार्वाक / लोकायत) is materialist and accepts **perception** only (**Pratyaksha** (प्रत्यक्ष) / प्रत्यक्ष प्रमाण).
9. **Bhagavatism** is the early **Vasudeva-Krishna** cult centred on **Mathura** (मथुरा). The **Heliodorus** pillar at Besnagar shows a Greek ambassador as a Bhagavata.
10. **Lumbini** (Buddha's birth) is in **Nepal**, not Uttar Pradesh — a common geography trap.
11. **Rummindei** (रुम्मिनदेई) (Ashoka) proves Lumbini as birthplace.
12. **Mahapajapati** is the first nun, ordained at Vaishali through **Ananda**.
13. **Triratna** = Buddha, Dhamma, Sangha.
14. **Nayaputta** is Mahavira, not Buddha.
15. **Karle** has the largest western Hinayana **chaitya** hall. **Bhaja, Bedsa, and Kondane** are sister western chaitya sites.
16. **Ajanta** is famous for Buddhist **paintings** (Phase I aniconic / Hinayana; Phase II Mahayana Padmapani). **Ellora** is multi-religion: Buddhist 1–12, Hindu 13–29, Jain 30–34; Cave **16** Kailasa is **Shaiva**.
17. **Sanchi** and **Bharhut** are early stupa / railing sites. Sanchi is **not** tied to one Buddha-life episode the way Lumbini, Bodh Gaya, Sarnath, and Kushinagar are.
18. **Nalanda** carries a Gupta–**Kumaragupta I** foundation tradition. **Vikramashila** is Pala **Dharmapala** (also founded **Somapura Mahavihara** at Paharpur). **Odantapuri** is Pala **Gopala**; **Jagaddala** is Pala **Ramapala**. **Vallabhi** was founded by Maitraka ruler **Bhattarka** in Gujarat.
19. **First Council** (Rajagriha, Ajatashatru, Mahakassapa) compiles Sutta–Vinaya; **Second** (Vaishali) splits Sthavira / Mahasanghika; **Third** (Pataliputra, Ashoka, Moggaliputta) adds Abhidhamma / missions; **Fourth** (Kundalvana, Kanishka, Vasumitra) seals Mahayana–Hinayana memory.
20. **Bhumisparsha mudra** shows the earth-touching gesture that witnesses enlightenment against Mara.
21. **Kaundinya** understood first. The other four were Bhadrika, Vashpa, Mahanaman, and Ashvajit.
22. **Anathapindika** gifted **Jetavana** at Shravasti (Kosala); Prasenajit / family patronage and **Pubbarama** are also remembered.
23. **Upali** held the Vinaya because he remembered the monastic rules.
24. **Sariputta** and **Moggallana** were the chief pair of disciples.
25. **Mahaparinirvana** came at age **80** at **Kushinagar** in Uttar Pradesh (Malla capital), between sala trees.
26. **Yogacara / Vijnanavada** is linked to **Asanga** and **Vasubandhu** (वसुबंधु).
27. **Nagasena** answers Milinda. **Nagarjuna** wrote *Madhyamaka Karika*. **Kumarila Bhatta** is Mimamsa.
28. **Triratna** of Buddhism = **Buddha**, **Dhamma** (धम्म), **Sangha** — not the Jain three jewels.
29. **Hinayana** means "lesser vehicle." It is a **Mahayana label**, not a name the early monks chose for themselves.

30. **Hinayana is not the same word as Theravada.** Theravada is the **only surviving** Hinayana school. Sarvastivada, Mahasanghika, and the rest are extinct in India.
31. **Theravada** spread to Sri Lanka through **Mahinda** and **Sanghamitta** after Ashoka's Third Council.
32. **Sarvastivada** is the school tied to **Kanishka's Fourth Council** in Kashmir, where **Vasumitra** presided and the ***Mahavibhasha*** was compiled.
33. **Vaibhasika (Vaibhashika)** and **Sautrantika** are **Sarvastivada subschools**, not separate vehicles like Mahayana.
34. **Mahasanghika** is the Vaishali split school. **Mahayana** is a later great vehicle.
35. **Mahayana** means “great vehicle.” It is the later Buddhist movement that grows from about the **1st century CE** onward in India, after the early Hinayana schools had already split.

Chapter 07: Sixth Century BCE

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **8 in Modern Uttar Pradesh:** Kashi, Kosala, Vatsa, Malla, Surasena, Panchala, Kuru (partly), Chedi (partly).
2. **3 in Bihar:** Magadha, Anga, Vajji.
3. **1 in Madhya Pradesh:** Avanti (plus parts of Chedi).
4. **1 in Rajasthan:** Matsya.
5. **1 in South India (Godavari basin):** Ashmaka (Assaka).
6. **2 in Northwest / Beyond Indus:** Gandhara, Kamboja.
7. **Gana-Sanghas (Republics / Non-monarchical): Vajji** (8 confederate clans) and **Malla** (two branches: Pava and Kushinara).
8. **Vajji** was a confederacy with capital **Vaishali** (वैशाली) (called *Magadhham Puram* in the Suttanipata). **Malla** held **Kushinagar** (कुशीनगर) and **Pava**. **Asmaka** was the only mahajanapada **south of the Vindhyas**.
9. **Rajagriha / Girivraja** was early Magadha's hill capital. **Ajatashatru** (अजातशत्रु) fortifies / founds the **Pataligrama** seed; **Udayin** first makes **Pataliputra** (पाटलिपुत्र) the capital (Ganga north, Son west).
10. **Shishunaga** rule took **Avanti**. **Kalashoka** is linked with the **Second Buddhist Council**. The last Shishunaga is often named **Nandivardhana**.
11. **Mahapadma Nanda** is remembered as *ekarat* (एकराट्) / *sarvakshatrantaka* (सर्वक्षत्रान्तक) / *ugrasena* (उग्रसेन) / *aparoparashurama* (अपरोपरशुराम). **Dhana Nanda** was the last Nanda, called **Agrammes** by the Greeks; commander **Bhaddasala**.
12. **Monarchy** means hereditary kingship. **Gana-sangha** (गण-संघ) means oligarchic clan-council rule, as in Vajji. **Yaudheya** is a later gana — not in the Buddha-period "early republic" list that papers use.
13. **NBPW** (Northern Black Polished Ware) is the deluxe black pottery of mahajanapada / early historic cities. It is **not** Later Vedic **PGW**.
14. **Champa** (epic **Malini**) was the river-port capital of **Anga**. **Varanasi** was the capital of **Kashi**. Do not swap them.
15. **Potana** is the Asmaka capital in standard match lists. Later **Pratishthana / Paithan** belongs to Satavahana geography, not the 2020 Asmaka key.
16. **Kushinagar** and **Pava** are **Malla** towns. Jain **Pavapuri** (पावापुरी) (Mahavira's nirvana) is a Magadha-site fact, not the same as Malla Pava in every stem.
17. **Ajatashatru** is the parricide king who broke the Licchavi confederacy. **Bimbisara** is the alliance-builder who took Anga. **Jivaka** was Bimbisara's physician, sent also to treat **Chanda Pradyota** of Avanti.
18. **Udayana–Vasavadatta** (Bhasa's *Svapnavasavadattam* (स्वप्नवासवदत्तम्)) is tied to **Ujjain** (उज्जैन), not to Kaushambi alone as the love-story setting.
19. **Kalpi** (ancient **Kalpriya**) sits on the **Yamuna** (यमुना) in Jalaun (UP). Dynasty dates for Magadha houses: Haryanka → Shishunaga → Nanda → Maurya → Shunga.
20. **Prasenjit** of **Kosala** (Shravasti) is Buddha's contemporary monarch. **Udayana** of **Vatsa** (Kaushambi) is the other famous middle-Ganga king of the same horizon.
21. **Ghositarama** at Kaushambi is the famous Buddhist monastery of the Vatsa capital. **Saheth–Maheth** is the twin mound of **Shravasti**.
22. **Iron** ploughs and weapons open forest in the middle Ganga. The **chaturanga** army has infantry, cavalry, chariots, and elephants.
23. **NBPW** (about 700–200 BCE) is the deluxe table-ware of this urban phase. It **starts in mahajanapada towns** and continues into the Mauryas. **PGW** is the Later Vedic doab ware.
24. **Punch-marked** silver (*karshapana*, bent bars), also called **Aahat** coins, appears. There is no gold dinara yet. These are the earliest extant Indian coins and run from about the seventh–sixth centuries BCE into the Mauryan age.
25. **Panini** of **Pushkalavati** (Gandhara) in the *Ashtadhyayi* names about **22** janapadas. The three he stresses as important are **Magadha, Asmaka, and Kamboja**.
26. **Iron tools** opened forest land and strengthened plough agriculture in the middle Ganga.
27. **Fortified towns** with ramparts, craft quarters, and administrative centres multiplied.

28. **Punch-marked silver** (*karshapana*) eased wider exchange; writing spread on pots and seals.
29. **NBPW** marks elite urban table culture; it begins in mahajanapada towns and continues into Mauryan strata.
30. **Champa** is a Ganga **emporium** in the Bhagalpur–Munger belt. Epic and Puranic memory also call it **Malini**.
31. **Girivraja / Rajagriha** sits in a ring of five hills. Iron and elephants are the resource facts.
32. **Jivaka** was sent from Magadha to treat him. Avanti falls to **Shishunaga**.
33. **Taxila** (तक्षशिला) is the university-town and an Achaemenid satrapy. **Pushkalavati** is the second pole.
34. **Vajji** united **eight clans**. Leading houses were the **Licchavis** of Vaishali, the **Videhas** of Mithila, and the **Jnatrikas** (Mahavira's clan).
35. **Malla** was a gana with two centres: **Kushinagar** and **Pava**.

Chapter 08: Foreign Invasions

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Darius I** (about **518 BCE**) took **Gandhara** (गांधार) and **Hindush** as the **20th** satrapy with gold-dust tribute. Behistun lists many provinces of his empire; Herodotus makes India the twentieth. **Skylax** explored the Indus. **Kharoshthi** (खरोष्ठी) grew from Aramaic. **Ctesias** was physician to **Artaxerxes II**.
2. **Alexander** entered India about **327–325 BCE** (year often **326**). The campaign lasted roughly **19 months**. He returned west from the Indus mouth / Paatal region about **325 BCE**.
3. **Ambhi** of Taxila was Alexander's **ally**. **Porus** fought him at the **Hydaspes (Jhelum)** and was then restored and enlarged.
4. **Kalanos** went with Alexander and later self-immolated. **Dandamis** refused to follow. **Aristotle** tutored Alexander but **never** came to India. **Deimachus** also did **not** come with Alexander — he is later Seleucid envoy to **Bindusara** (बिन्दुसार).
5. **Seleucus Nicator** fought Chandragupta about **305–303 BCE**, ceded Arachosia, Gedrosia, and Paropamisadae, and received **500 elephants** plus the envoy **Megasthenes** (मेगस्थनीज).
6. **Shakas** (Indo-Scythians) used the title **kshatrapa**. **Maues / Moga** was first strong at Taxila–Gandhara.
7. **Sudarshana lake** history runs **Pushyagupta** (Chandragupta Maurya) → **Tushaspha** (Ashoka) → repair by **Rudradaman**.
8. **Parthians (Pahlavas)** under **Gondophares** (about **19–45 CE**) held a brief north-west phase, remembered at **Takht-i-Bahi**, before the Kushan peak.
9. **Devaputra** (देवपुत्र) is a Kushan royal title. The **Rabatak** inscription helps Kushan genealogy.
10. **Sagala** is Menander's Sialkot seat. **Sangala** is the Kathaioi town Alexander stormed. Do not merge the spellings.
11. **Bucephala** commemorated Alexander's horse. **Nicaea** commemorated victory after Hydaspes.
12. **Megasthenes** was Seleucus's envoy after the Chandragupta treaty. **Nearchus** was Alexander's admiral. Keep envoy and admiral separate.
13. **Maues** is Shaka at Taxila. **Gondophares** is Parthian at Takht-i-Bahi. **Kanishka** is the Kushan peak — three different horizons.
14. **Hathigumpha** is Kharavela's Kalinga cave text. **Junagadh** is Rudradaman's Shaka rock. Do not swap those epigraphs.
15. **Gandhara** art uses grey / green **schist** and Greco-Roman Buddha modelling in the NW. **Mathura** art uses mottled **red sandstone** and indigenous types in **UP**.
16. **Megasthenes** did **not** march with Alexander. He comes after the Seleucus treaty.
17. **Cyrus** (died 530 BCE) reaches the Indus fringe in **legend** only. The **satrapy** is **Darius I**, about **518/516 BCE**.
18. **Skylax of Caryanda** sails the Indus to the sea. Persepolis and Naqsh-i-Rustam reliefs show Indian delegates.
19. **Xerxes** took Indian infantry and archers into the Persian host against the Greeks. Herodotus records this.
20. **Ctesias** served as state physician to **Artaxerxes II** and wrote on India–Persia from that court world.
21. **Ambhi / Omphis** of Taxila **submits** and becomes an ally.
22. **Abisares** of Kashmir sends gifts and does not fight.
23. **Phegeus** warns him of Nanda numbers.
24. **Nearchus** sails from the Indus mouth to the Gulf.
25. **Philip** is a satrap and is later murdered.
26. **Peithon** holds the lower Indus.
27. **Eudemus** is a leftover officer.
28. **Sandrokottos = Chandragupta** is the peg of **William Jones**. Magadha and Buddha dates hang on this.
29. **Aristobulus** is an engineer and writer, an eyewitness behind Arrian. **Ptolemy I** is a general whose memoir also feeds Arrian. He later becomes a Pharaoh. He is **not** an Indian king.
30. **Nearchus** is the admiral who sails from the Indus mouth to the Persian Gulf. **Onesicritus** is the helmsman who writes of gymnosophists, the "naked philosophers."
31. **Craterus** is a general sent **overland** with veterans. **Coenus** is the voice of the **Beas** mutiny.
32. **Seleucus** is an officer on the march, but his Indian war is **after** Alexander. **Hephaestion** is Alexander's intimate and chiliarch. He is on the Indian march. He dies in 324. He is not the Beas story.

33. **Callisthenes** is the court historian and Aristotle's kin. He is killed **before** India, in the proskynesis row. **Eudemus** is left in the Punjab as a post-323 leftover.
34. **Aristotle** did **not** march to India. He was tutor in Macedon only.
35. **Megasthenes** did **not** march to India. He is a Seleucid envoy about **303**, at Chandragupta's court.

Chapter 09: Mauryan Empire

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Rock Edict XII** teaches **samavaya** (समवाय) — religious concord / synthesis. Do not give that role to RE XIII.
2. **Dhamma-mahamatras** (धम्म महामात्र) were appointed in Ashoka's **14th year** (RE V). Dhamma is ethical **state policy**, not identical with the Buddhist religion he patronised.
3. **Barabar** caves were gifted to **Ajivikas** (आजीविक). Their polish is Mauryan; they are not Ajanta-style Buddhist painted caves.
4. **Kanaganahalli** (कनगनाहल्ली) preserves a label reading **"Raya Asoka."** Schism edicts appear at Sarnath and **Kaushambi** (कौशांबी).
5. **Samaharta** (समाहर्ता) collects revenue. **Sannidhata** (सन्निधाता) stores the treasury (**kosha** (कोष)). Never reverse collector and storekeeper.
6. **Rajuka** (रज्जुक) handled land and justice (pillar edicts). **Dhamma-mahamatras** (धम्म महामात्र) handled moral and welfare work (RE V).
7. **Bhaga** (भाग) is the produce share. **Bali** (बलि) is an extra or religious levy. Rummindei notes remission of *bali* at Lumbini.
8. **Sudama** and **Lomas Rishi** (लोमश ऋषि) are Barabar cells; Lomas Rishi shows the famous horseshoe chaitya-arch facade.
9. **Bindusara** is remembered as **Amitraghata** (अमित्रघात - "slayer of foes") and held the empire between Chandragupta and Ashoka. Greek writers call him Amitrochates.
10. **Bherighosha** (भेरीघोष) is the war-drum. **Dhammaghosha** (धम्मघोष) is the dhamma-drum of RE IV / XIII — Ashoka's metaphor for moral conquest.
11. **Sohgaura** (Gorakhpur, UP) and **Mahasthan** (महास्थान) (Bangladesh) are Mauryan famine / grain-store records. Mauryas did **not** make religious land grants as a system (that epigraphy starts with Satavahanas).
12. **Pranaya** (प्रणय) is the Mauryan **emergency** tax. **Sita** (सीता) is crown-land produce under the *sitadhyaksha* (सीताध्यक्ष). *Pankodakasannirodhe* (पंकोदकसन्निरोधे) is the penalty for fouling roads with mud and water.
13. **Vishnugupta** (विष्णुगुप्त) is Chanakya's other name (papers often treat it as the childhood / alternate identity). *Arthashastra* is compared with Machiavelli's *Prince*. *Mudrarakshasa* (मुद्राराक्षस) calls Chandragupta **Vrishal / Kulheen**; Dhundiraja wrote a commentary.
14. **Justin** remembers Sandrokottos meeting Alexander. **William Jones** first equated Sandrokottos with Chandragupta Maurya. Jain texts call Bindusara **Simhasena**; his mother is **Durdhara**.
15. **Sanchi** (Raisen, MP) is the best-preserved early stupa core begun under Ashoka. **Bharhut** railings bloom mainly in the **Shunga** age — do not treat both as identical Ashokan art facts.
16. **Plutarch** calls him **Androcottus**.
17. **Justin** calls him **Sandrokottos** and remembers a meeting with **Alexander**.
18. **William Jones** first equated Sandrokottos with **Chandragupta Maurya** (चंद्रगुप्त मौर्य).
19. **Chanakya** (चाणक्य) is also called **Kautilya** (कौटिल्य).
20. **Dhundiraja** (धुन्दिराज) wrote a commentary on *Mudrarakshasa*.
21. **Kunala** is a legendary blinded heir. He is not a hard epigraphic king.
22. **Dasharatha** gifts the **Nagarjuni** caves to the Ajivikas. Tradition often places him in the eastern share.
23. **Samprati** is the Jain "second Chandragupta." Tradition often places him in the western and southern share.
24. **Salisuka** is a Puranic name only.
25. **Devavarman** is a Puranic name only.
26. **Satadhanvan** is a Puranic name only.
27. **James Prinsep** deciphered Brahmi in **1837**.
28. **NBPW** continues under the Mauryas. It began in mahajanapada towns, not only under Ashoka.
29. **Ring-wells** mark Mauryan settlement layers.
30. **Kautilya** describes adhyakshas, spies, and taxes.
31. **Megasthenes** describes six city boards, six army boards, and seven classes.

32. **Tosali** is the Kalinga post.
33. **Agronomai** work as **revenue / land** officers. That is the accepted key.
34. **Lanka** receives **Mahinda** and **Sanghamitta**, under king **Devanampiya Tissa**, with a Bodhi-sapling.
35. **Jalauka** in Kashmir is from the *Rajatarangini* (राजतरंगिणी), not from edicts.

Chapter 10: Post-Mauryan India

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Hathigumpha** at Udayagiri (Odisha) belongs to **Kharavela** (खारवेल) of Kalinga, a Jain Mahameghavahana / Chedi king. Ashoka, Harsha, and Kanishka are the usual wrong options.
2. **Gautamiputra Satakarni** (गौतमीपुत्र शातकर्णि) defeated Shaka **Nahapana** (नहपान) of the **Kshaharata** house. The victory is recorded in the **Nasik prasasti** of **Gautami Balashri**.
3. **Karikala** is the Sangam Chola who built the **Kallanai** on the Kaveri. He is **not** imperial **Rajaraja I** of Thanjavur.
4. **Gandhara** art is Kushan northwest Greco-Buddhist. **Amaravati** art is Satavahana Andhra limestone narrative relief. Do not swap the schools.
5. **Patanjali** (पतंजलि) of the *Mahabhashya* (महाभाष्य) and Kalidasa's (कालिदास) *Malavikagnimitra* (मालविकाग्निमित्रम्) (Agnimitra (अग्निमित्र)) sit in Shunga-court tradition, but Buddhist books stay hostile to Pushyamitra even while Sanchi still grows. **Patanjali is Shunga-age — not Kanishka's court.**
6. **Vima Kadphises** (Kadphises II) issues the first large-scale **gold** for regular use; title **Sarvalokeshvara**. **Kujula** mainly issues **copper**. **Kanishka** puts **Buddha** (बुद्ध) on coins.
7. **Rabatak** lists Kushan cities **Saketa, Kaushambi, Pataliputra, and Champa** — **not Shravasti**. Sarnath Kanishka Buddha image inscription is dated about **81 CE** (year 3 of his era).
8. **Ashvaghosha** (*Buddhacharita*, *Saundarananda*, *Sariputraprakarana* (शारिपुत्रप्रकरण)), **Vasumitra**, **Nagarjuna** (नागार्जुन), **Parsva**, and physician **Charaka** (चरक) adorn Kanishka's court. Chinese texts remember **Pan Chao** defeating Kanishka's force.
9. **Gautamiputra Satakarni** is **Ekabrahmana** / protector of the varna order (Nasik of Gautami Balashri). Satavahanas issue punch-marked, lead, copper, silver, potin — **not gold**. **Matsya Purana** gives the longest Andhra list (~30 kings).
10. **Strato II** issued **lead** coins. **Agathocles** put **Sankarshana (Balarama) and Vasudeva** on bilingual coins. Gandhara sculpture often uses **green schist**; **Bamiyan** held colossal Buddha images.
11. **Uraiyur** (also **Koli** / **Varanam**) on the Kaveri at Tiruchirappalli was the Sangam Chola capital and a major **cotton** centre in the *Periplus*.
12. **Vattakirutal** in Sangam poems is the defeated king's ritual suicide by **fasting unto death**.
13. **Udiyanjiral** belongs to the **Chera** line and is often treated as the first historical Chera of the Sangam age. Chera capital memory is **Vanji / Vanchi / Karuvur (Karur)**.
14. **Patanjali** belongs to the **Shunga** (शुंग) horizon. Do not put him in Kanishka's court.
15. **Ashvaghosha** belongs to **Kanishka**. Do not put him with Ashoka.
16. **Parthians** sit between Shakas and Kushans in fuller teaching. Papers sometimes drop them.
17. **Agnimitra** (अग्निमित्र) is Pushyamitra's son. Kalidasa's (कालिदास) *Malavikagnimitra* (मालविकाग्निमित्रम्) uses him.
18. **Patanjali** of the *Mahabhashya* is placed in this court in tradition. He is **not** a Kanishka-court scholar.
19. **Bharhut** (भरहुत) stupa railings are a classic **Shunga** sculpture fact.
20. **Heliodorus** at Besnagar is a Bhagavata Greek ambassador. He is also not the ashvamedha record.
21. **Hala** (17th ruler) was a poet-king and patron of literature who authored the celebrated Prakrit erotic anthology **Gathasaptasati (Sattasai)**; his contemporary **Gunadhya** composed the lost epic **Brihatkatha** in Paisachi Prakrit.
22. **Satakarni I** is the early expansion king and the first to hold the title **Satakarni**. The **Naneghat** inscription of queen **Naganika** belongs to this house.
23. **Gautamiputra Satakarni** is the greatest.
24. **Hathigumpha** belongs to **Kharavela** of Kalinga. Ashoka, Harsha, and Kanishka have **other** inscriptions.
25. **Megalithic** cultures are Iron Age burial traditions of the peninsula and parts of central India.
26. **PGW** is Later Vedic **doab** (दोआब) ware. **Megaliths** are mainly **south and Deccan** Iron Age burials.
27. **Greco-Bactria** breaks from the Seleucids under **Diodotus**, about **250 BCE**. **Demetrius I**, about **180 BCE**, makes the first major push into India with an elephant-scalp helmet type.
28. **Agathocles** and **Pantaleon** issue early bilingual coins with **Brahmi** (ब्राह्मी) legends and **Sankarshana (Balarama) / Vasudeva** types. **Apollodotus** is an early Indian-side silver king.

29. **Heliodorus**, ambassador of **Antialcidas**, raises the **Besnagar** (Vidisha) Garuda pillar about **113 BCE**. He calls himself a Bhagavata of **Vasudeva**.
30. **Gautamiputra Satakarni** defeats Nahapana. The **Nasik prasasti** of **Gautami Balashri** records the victory. Nahapana's silver was restruck.
31. **Rudradaman I** is Chashtana's grandson and the greatest western Shaka. He rules about **130–150 CE** as **mahakshatrapa** (महाक्षत्रप).
32. **Vikrama Samvat 57 BCE** is the Vikramaditya legend at Ujjain. It is **not** the **Shaka era 78 CE** tied to Kanishka. The two eras differ by **135 years**.
33. **Kujula Kadphises** of the Kushans displaces Parthian and remaining Greek power in the northwest.
34. **Vima Kadphises** (Kadphises II) issues the first large-scale **gold** coinage for regular use in India. Titles include **Shaonanoshao** (king of kings) and **Sarvalokeshvara**.
35. **Kanishka** is the greatest Kushan ruler.

Chapter 11: Gupta Age

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Sri Gupta** and **Ghatotkacha** carry only the title **Maharaja** (महाराज). The first Gupta **Maharajadhiraja** (महाराजाधिराज) is **Chandragupta I**.
2. **Samudragupta** is the digvijaya (**Digvijaya** / दिग्विजय) king. **V. A. Smith** called him the **Napoleon of India**. In the north he **uprooted** nine kings and annexed land; in the south he **defeated then restored** twelve kings as tribute.
3. **Chandragupta II (Vikramaditya)** (विक्रमादित्य) ended the Western Kshatrapas (क्षत्रप) by defeating **Rudrasimha III**. He took the title **Sakari** (शकारि - destroyer of Shakas). **Ujjain** (उज्जैन) became a second pole while Pataliputra stayed the old capital.
4. **Fa-Hien** (फाह्यान) visited India about **399–414 CE** under Chandragupta II. Traveller order is **Fa-Hien → Hiuen Tsang → I-Tsing → Al-Biruni**.
5. **Kumaragupta I (Mahendraditya)** (महेन्द्रादित्य) is the traditional founder-patron of **Nalanda** (नालंदा). Chinese visitors later studied there; they did not found it.
6. **Skandagupta** is the last great imperial Gupta. The **Bhitari** pillar (Ghazipur, UP) records his **Huna** war, and he also repaired the **Sudarsana** lake at Girnar.
7. **Nalanda** is Gupta (Kumaragupta I). **Takshashila** is the older Gandhara town. **Vikramashila** (विक्रमशिला) is Pala **Dharmapala** (धर्मपाल). **Vallabhi** is Maitraka Gujarat.
8. **Kalidasa** (कालिदास) belongs to the Chandragupta II (चंद्रगुप्त द्वितीय) court tradition. Plays (नाटक): *Abhijnanashakuntalam* (अभिज्ञानशाकुन्तलम्), *Malavikagnimitra* (मालविकाग्निमित्रम्), *Vikramorvashiyam* (विक्रमोर्वशीयम्). Mahakavyas (महाकाव्य): *Raghuvamsa* (रघुवंश), *Kumarasambhava* (कुमारसंभव). Lyrics (गीतिकाव्य): *Meghaduta* (मेघदूत), *Ritusamhara* (ऋतुसंहार). *Shringara Shataka* (शृंगार शतक) is **Bhartrihari** (भर्तृहरि), not Kalidasa.
9. **Bhitargaon** (भीतरगाँव) (Kanpur belt) is a Gupta-age brick temple in Uttar Pradesh. **Deogarh** (देवगढ़) Dashavatara is an early stone shikhara temple.
10. **Dashpur / Mandasor** silk-weavers' guild under **Bandhuvarman** (Kumaragupta I age) built and later repaired a **Sun** temple — often called India's earliest "advertisement" style record.
11. **Dhanvantari** (धन्वंतरि) is the Navaratna medicine name. **Bhaskara II** (भास्कर द्वितीय) (*Lilavati* (लीलावती), *Siddhanta Shiromani* (सिद्धांत शिरोमणि)) is **12th century**, not a Gupta contemporary.
12. **Kalidasa** (कालिदास) is not the author of *Shringara Shataka* (शृंगार शतक) (**Bhartrihari** (भर्तृहरि)).
13. **V. A. Smith** in *The Early History of India* called him the **Napoleon of India** for his campaigns.
14. **Ujjain** becomes a second pole. **Pataliputra** stays the old capital.
15. **Udayagiri** in Madhya Pradesh has Varaha / Vishnu caves.
16. **Fa-Hien (Faxian)** was in India **399–414 CE** during this reign to collect authentic Buddhist Vinaya texts.
17. **Crucial UPPCS Trap:** In his entire travelogue (*Fo-Kwo-Ki / Record of Buddhist Kingdoms*), **Fa-Hien NEVER mentions the name of Emperor Chandragupta II or his royal court**, despite praising the peace, absence of capital punishment, and prosperity of the Middle Kingdom (Madhyadesha).
18. **Brahmadeya / agrahara** grants punch holes in the crown's direct take.
19. **Master Land Classifications: Kshetra** (cultivated land), **Khila** (waste/fallow land), **Aprahata** (jungle/forest land), **Vasti** (habitable land), **Gapata-Sarah** (pasture land).
20. **Revenue & Taxes: Bhaga** (king's 1/6th customary share), **Bhoga** (daily gift of fruits/flowers), **Kara** (periodic tax), **Bali** (customary offering), **Udranga** (water tax / fixed land tax), **Uparikara** (extra tax on temporary tenants), **Vishti** (forced unpaid labour).
21. **Kumaramatya** = all-purpose district executive. Damodarpur plates name him.
22. **Ayuktaka** = appointed district officer. Same band as kumaramatya.
23. **Pustapala** = record-keeper of grants.
24. **Dutaka** = carries the grant / royal order.
25. **Ishanavarman**–Haraha / Sarvavarman–Gaya pairs are **Maukhari / later Gupta**, not this imperial set. Gaya plate is still Samudragupta.
26. **Silver rupaka** = Chandragupta II after the Shaka war. **~33 grains**.

27. **Hiuen Tsang** (ह्वेनसांग) studies here during **Harsha's** reign. **I-tsing** visits later. Both are **visitors**, not founders.
28. **Takshashila (Taxila)** is the older northwest teaching town in Gandhara. **Chanakya** (चाणक्य), **Panini** (पाणिनि), and **Jivaka** belong to its tradition. It is **not** a Gupta foundation.
29. **Vikramashila** in the Bhagalpur belt is a **Pala** foundation under **Dharmapala**. It peaks after Nalanda's Gupta start.
30. **Vallabhi** in Gujarat is a **Maitraka** centre of learning. The **Svetambara Jain canon** council is linked to Vallabhi. Vallabhi is **not** Vaishali.
31. **Bhitargaon** in the Kanpur belt of Uttar Pradesh is a brick temple.
32. **Eran** has a Varaha and pillars.
33. **Tigawa** in Madhya Pradesh is a flat-roof shrine.
34. **Kalidasa** (कालिदास) belongs to the Chandragupta II (चंद्रगुप्त द्वितीय) tradition.
35. **Sudraka** (शूद्रक) wrote *Mrichchhakatika* (मृच्छकटिकम्) (*The Little Clay Cart*). It is the urban love story of merchant **Charudatta** (चारुदत्त) and courtesan **Vasantasena** (वसन्तसेना), and it also mirrors city administration and society in a Gupta-age Ujjain setting.

Chapter 12: Post-Gupta Period

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Harsha** (हर्ष) of the **Pushyabhuti** house ruled **606–647 CE**. He is a post-Gupta reunion king, **not** a Gupta emperor. **Harsha-samvat** starts in **606 CE**. Founder-memory of the house is **Pushyabhuti**.
2. **Banabhatta** (बाणभट्ट) is Harsha's court poet from **Pritikuta** (Son bank, Bihar tradition / Shravasti belt in notes). He writes ornate Sanskrit prose, not Gupta-age verse drama like **Kalidasa** (कालिदास). *Rajatarangini* (राजतरंगिणी) of Kalhana (कल्हण) also carries later Harsha-age memory.
3. **Hiuen Tsang (Xuanzang)** was in India about **630–644**, studied at **Nalanda** (नालंदा) under **Shilabhadra**, and wrote the ***Si-Yu-Ki***. He is Harsha's Chinese witness, not Fa-Hien.
4. **Sarvavarman–Gaya copper plate** is **NOT** matched. The Gaya plate is Gupta / **Samudragupta** (समुद्रगुप्त). Sarvavarman's fact is the **Asirgarh** seal.
5. **Rajyashri did not marry Dhruvasena** of Valabhi. She is Grihavarman's widow; Maitraka **Dhruvasena II** was restored as an ally.
6. **I-tsing** comes by sea after Harsha (~671–695), studies at Nalanda, and returns via Sumatra.
7. **Pushyabhuti** house founder-memory is **Pushyabhuti**; Harsha's Chinese title is **Siladitya**. Do not call Harsha a Gupta emperor.
8. **Banabhatta** wrote *Harshacharita* and *Kadambari*. **Mayura** wrote *Suryashataka*.
9. **Yashodharman** of Malwa boasts the Huna check at **Mandasor** (Dashapura), about **532 CE**. **Vasula** is the composer remembered for the **Sondani / Sondhni** record of that victory.
10. **Gauda** is Bengal under **Shashanka**, with capital **Karnasuvarna**.
11. **Harsha-samvat** starts in **606 CE**.
12. **Ishanavarman — Haraha** is **correct**. It is Barabanki, UP. VS 611 / **554 CE**.
13. **Ishvaravarman — Jaunpur stone** is **correct** in that paper. He is father of Ishanavarman.
14. **Jivitagupta II — Deo-Baranark** is **correct**. It is Bhojpur, Bihar.
15. **Sarvavarman — Gaya copper plate** is **NOT matched**. The Gaya plate is Gupta / **Samudragupta**. Sarvavarman is the **Asirgarh** seal.
16. **Harshavardhan** is a common trap option for **Hathigumpha**. The inscription belongs to **Kharavela** of Kalinga, not Harsha.
17. **Mahasamanta** feudatories sit under him. The grip is less tight than Mauryan amatyas. Agrahara grants to Brahmans go on. The court can move as a camp (**skandhavara**).
18. **Rajyashri did not marry Dhruvasena.** She is Grihavarman's widow.
19. ***Harshacharita*** (हर्षचरित) is "Deeds of Harsha," a prose **biography** of his patron. Class: **akhyayika** (आख्यायिका).
20. ***Kadambari*** (कादंबरी) is a long **romance** named after the heroine. Class: **katha** (कथा). Not a second Harsha chronicle. He left it unfinished. Tradition: son **Bhushanabhatta** (भूषणभट्ट) finished it.
21. **Banabhatta** (बाणभट्ट) is Harsha's **7th-century** court poet. **Kalidasa** (कालिदास) is Chandragupta II's (चंद्रगुप्त द्वितीय) Gupta-age poet.
22. **Ucchvasa 1** = Bana's own life (rare author-autobiography).
23. **Fa-Hien** came two centuries earlier, under **Chandragupta II** (चंद्रगुप्त द्वितीय) (about 399–414), mainly for **Vinaya**. Xuanzang came for **Mahayana** texts. Nalanda itself was founded under **Kumaragupta I**. Xuanzang is the **visitor**, not the founder.
24. **Sung-yun** (Song Yun) came about **518–521** under the Northern Wei — after Fa-Hien, before Xuanzang.
25. **I-Tsing** comes by **sea** after Harsha (about 671–695). He is still at Nalanda. He is not Harsha's guest. **Al-Biruni** writes ***Kitab-ul-Hind*** under Mahmud (about 1017). He is last in the 2024 list.
26. **Hiuen Tsang** studies under **Shilabhadra** at Nalanda and spends years in Magadha recording campus life, libraries, and debate.
27. **Toramana** is the early Huna king who pushes into north India.
28. **Mihirakula** follows him. The Gwalior inscription remembers him. His seat is at **Sakala**.
29. **Yashodharman** of Malwa boasts victory at **Mandasor / Sondani** about **532 CE**. The composer is **Vasula**.
30. **Badami rock inscription** of Pulakeshin I dated Saka 465 = $465 + 78 + 58 = 601$ Vikrama Samvat.
31. **Chalukya inscription** dated Saka 556 = $556 + 78 = 634$ CE.

32. **Gadhaiya coins:** Sassanian-inspired silver coins circulated in western India during early medieval times.
33. **Center of Gravity:** Trade and political supremacy shifted from Ujjain to **Kannauj (Mahodaya / Mahodayashri)** on the fertile Ganga-Yamuna doab, triggering the tripartite struggle (Palas, Pratiharas, Rashtrakutas).
34. **Maukharis of Kannauj:** Rose as feudatories of Guptas from Gaya; kings: Hari Varma, Aditya Varma, Ishana Varma (**Haraha inscription, 554 CE**), Sarva Varma (**Asirgarh copper seal**), Graha Varma (married Harsha's sister Rajyashri).
35. **Harshavardhana (606–647 CE):**

Chapter 13: Ancient Indian Administration

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Ashoka** on edicts is **Devanampiya Piyadassi** (देवानांप्रिय प्रियदर्शी). His personal name appears at **Maski** (and Gujarra, Nittur, Udegolam). **Bindusara** is **Amitraghata** (अमित्रघात).
2. **Chandragupta I** is the first Gupta **Maharajadhiraja** (महाराजाधिराज). **Chandragupta II** is **Vikramaditya** (विक्रमादित्य). **Harsha** is Chinese **Siladitya** (शीलादित्य). **Kanishka** is **Devaputra** (देवपुत्र).
3. **Gautamiputra Satakarni** is **Dakshinapathapati** (दक्षिणापथपति). **Kharavela** is **Mahameghavahana** (महामेघवाहन). **Rudradaman I** is **Mahakshatrapa** (महाक्षत्रप). **Mahapadma Nanda** is **Ekarat / Sarvakshatrantaka** (एकराट् / सर्वक्षत्रान्तक).
4. **Hathigumpha** = **Kharavela**. **Ayodhya** (अयोध्या) = Pushyamitra's two **ashwamedhas**. **Besnagar** = Heliodorus, **not** Pushyamitra.
5. **Prayag Prashasti** (प्रयाग प्रशस्ति) = **Samudragupta** (समुद्रगुप्त) by **Harishena** on the Allahabad Ashokan shaft. **Aihole** (ऐहोल) = **Pulakeshin II** stopping Harsha.
6. **Girnar / Junagadh** rock carries three ages: **Ashoka**, then **Rudradaman** (रुद्रदामन), then **Skandagupta**.
7. **Sarvavarman–Gaya copper plate** is **NOT** matched. The Gaya plate is **Samudragupta**. Sarvavarman's fact is the **Asirgarh** seal.
8. **Nasik prasasti** of Gautami Balashri records Gautamiputra against Nahapana. **Naneghat** records queen **Naganika** with Satakarni I.
9. **Mehrauli** (मेहरौली) iron pillar's "Chandra" is usually **Chandragupta II**. **Bhitari** pillar is **Skandagupta** versus the Hunas. **Banskhera** and **Madhuban** are Harsha grants.
10. **Rajuka** (रज्जुक) is Mauryan district land and justice. **Uparika** (उपरिक) is Gupta provincial governor. Do not swap the ages.
11. **Chandragupta Maurya** (चंद्रगुप्त मौर्य) is Greek **Sandrokottos** (~322 BCE). He is **not** Chandragupta I or Chandragupta II of the Gupta house.
12. **Rummindei** (रुम्मिनदेई) pillar records Ashoka's Lumbini visit. **Rabatak** gives Kanishka genealogy. **Haraha** (554 CE) is Maukhari Ishanavarman in Barabanki, UP.
13. **Mahapadma Nanda** is **Ekarat** (एकराट्) and **Sarvakshatrantaka** (सर्वक्षत्रान्तक).
14. **Chandragupta Maurya** is Greek **Sandrokottos**.
15. **Bindusara** is **Amitraghata** (अमित्रघात) / **Amitrochates**.
16. **Ashoka** is **Devanampiya Piyadassi** (देवानांप्रिय प्रियदर्शी) on most edicts.
17. **Kanishka** is **Devaputra** (देवपुत्र).
18. **Gautamiputra Satakarni** is **Dakshinapathapati** (दक्षिणापथपति).
19. **Kharavela** is **Mahameghavahana** (महामेघवाहन) of the Chedi line.
20. **Rudradaman I** is **Mahakshatrapa** (महाक्षत्रप).
21. **Sri Gupta** and **Ghatotkacha** are **Maharaja** (महाराज) only.
22. **Chandragupta I** is the first Gupta **Maharajadhiraja** (महाराजाधिराज).
23. **Samudragupta** is Maharajadhiraja and *kaviraja* (कविराज). Digvijaya is the **policy**, not a coin-title.
24. **Chandragupta II** is **Vikramaditya** (विक्रमादित्य).
25. **Kumaragupta I** is **Mahendraditya** (महेन्द्रादित्य).
26. **Skandagupta** is **Kramaditya** (क्रमादित्य) or Vikramaditya on some types.
27. **Harsha** is Chinese **Siladitya** (शीलादित्य). He is also Paramabhattaraka (परमभट्टारक).
28. **Chakravartin** (चक्रवर्ती) is the ideal wheel-turning monarch. It is not one king's exclusive stamp.
29. **Ashoka** issues Major and Minor Rock Edicts and Pillar edicts. The personal name is rare. It appears at **Maski**. His **Rummindei** pillar records the Lumbini visit.
30. **Girnar / Junagadh** carries Ashoka, then Rudradaman, then Skandagupta. Three ages sit on **one** rock.
31. **Pushyamitra Shunga** is recorded at **Ayodhya** for two **ashwamedhas**.
32. **Heliodorus** raises the **Besnagar** Bhagavata pillar. It is **not** Pushyamitra.
33. **Kharavela** is recorded at **Hathigumpha**, Udayagiri. Harsha is a common wrong option.

34. **Gautamiputra Satakarni** is recorded in the **Nasik** (नासिक) prasasti of Gautami Balashri. He beats Nahapana.

35. **Naganika** is recorded at **Naneghat**, with Satakarni I.

Chapter 14: Ancient Indian Economy

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Indo-Greeks** bring the first **portrait** die-struck coins, with Greek and Kharoshthi legends. Portraits do **not** begin with the Guptas.
2. **Vima Kadphises** and the **Kushans** make gold coinage common in India. Gupta **dinara** (दीनार) is later prestige gold named through the Roman *denarius* path.
3. **Yajna Sri Satakarni** put a **ship** on some Satavahana coins as a Deccan sea-trade stamp.
4. **Shreni** (श्रेणी) is the general craft or trade guild headed by a **shreshthin** (श्रेष्ठिन्) or **jyeshthaka** (ज्येष्ठक). **Nigama** (निगम) is a merchant association; **Sarthavaha** (सार्थवाह) is the caravan leader. **Nagaram** (नगरम) is a south Indian town merchant body.
5. **Manigrama** (मणिग्रामम) is the **foreign / overseas** trade institution. **Nanadesi** (नानादेशी) means merchants of many lands, but the foreign-trade key is still **Manigrama**.
6. **Lothal** is the Harappan **dockyard** (गोदीबाड़ा). Boat models come from **Mohenjo-daro and Lothal**, not from Dholavira alone.
7. **Tamralipti** (ताम्रलिप्ति) at the Ganga mouth faces the Bay of Bengal. **Muziris (Muchiri)** on the Malabar is the Roman **pepper** (काली मिर्च) port.
8. **Sopara** (शूर्पारक) and **Kalyan** on the Konkan run from Mauryan times onward. **Puhar / Kaveripattinam** is the Sangam Chola port at the Kaveri mouth. **Uraiyur** is the Sangam Chola capital and a **cotton** centre.
9. **Tagara** sat on the inland trade route connecting **Kalyan** with **Vengi**.
10. **Lothal** on the Gulf of Khambhat is the Harappan **dockyard**. **Sutkagen-dor** on the Makran is the Harappan west end. Boat **models** come from **Mohenjo-daro and Lothal**. Dholavira is not that pair.
11. **Bharukaccha / Broach** at the Narmada mouth is Periplus **Barygaza**. **Sopara** and **Kalyan** on the Konkan run from Mauryan times onward. **Barbarikon** is the Indus-mouth Periplus port. It is **not** Broach.
12. **Tamralipti** at the Ganga mouth faces the Bay of Bengal.
13. **Muziris (Muchiri)** on the Malabar is the Roman **pepper** port. **Nelcynda** in Kerala is another Periplus pepper landing. **Tondi** and **Mushiri** sit on the western *Periplus* list with them. **Puhar / Kaveripattinam** at the Kaveri mouth is the Sangam Chola port. **Arikamedu** near Puducherry yields Roman amphorae and was called **Poduke** in the *Periplus*.
14. **Uraiyur** on the Kaveri was a Sangam Chola capital and a major **cotton** centre.
15. **Tagara** was a significant inland trade centre on the route connecting **Kalyan** with **Vengi**.
16. **Pepper** is the famous west-coast export. Cotton, ivory, pearls, and gems also leave Indian ports. **Horses** are a famous import. Wine, gold, and glass also arrive from the west.
17. **Pliny** complains of a **gold drain** to India. Hoards of Roman gold and silver sit in Kerala, Tamil country, and Karnataka. **Arikamedu** yields amphorae and Arretine ware.
18. **First Indian coins = Gupta gold → punch-marked silver**.
19. **2022 Shaka proof = dinara → silver**, ~33 grains.
20. **33 grains = gold weight** → silver rupaka. Gold is ~120–144.
21. **King-queen gold = Chandragupta II → Chandragupta I**.
22. **Lyrist = Chandragupta II → Samudragupta**.
23. **Nishka = Mauryan coin** → Vedic gold **unit**.
24. **Shreni = 2018 foreign trade → Manigrama**.
25. **Shreni = only northern India** → north **and** south; quality/price/conduct are guild-controlled.
26. **Nanadesi = Manigrama** → many-lands vs overseas guild.
27. **Boat models = Dholavira → Mohenjo-daro + Lothal**.
28. **Barbarikon = Broach** → Indus mouth. Broach = **Barygaza**.
29. **Tamralipti = main Roman port → Muziris** / west-south.
30. **Lothal = Muziris** → Bronze Age dock vs Sangam–Roman pepper.
31. **IVC = pastoral → Urban** (2020). Pastoral = Rigvedic.

32. **Later Vedic = urban → agrarian**.
33. **Entrepot = any jetty** → warehouse / redistributor.
34. **Dakshinapatha = only sea** → inland north–Deccan road.
35. **Yavana = only a Greek king** → Sangam foreign / western trader.

Chapter 15: Archaeology

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **John Marshall** (DG 1902–1928) **announced** the Indus civilization to the world in **1924**. **Mortimer Wheeler** (DG 1944–1948) brought the **balk-and-grid** method and re-dug Harappa in **1946** — he did **not** discover IVC.
2. **Stratigraphy** (स्तरिकी) is relative dating by layers: in an undisturbed stack, **deeper is older**. A **balk** is the uncut wall left so layers can still be read.
3. **Carbon-14** is absolute dating invented on **Willard Libby's** path. Half-life is about **5730 years**. It works only on **organic** samples (charcoal, bone, wood, seed, shell) — not bare stone or metal.
4. **Daya Ram Sahni** opened **Harappa** in **1921**. **R.D. Banerjee** opened **Mohenjo-daro** (मोहनजोदड़ो) in **1922**. Marshall announced; Wheeler re-dug later.
5. **S.R. Rao** excavated **Lothal** and its dockyard. **B.B. Lal** excavated **Kalibangan** (कालीबंगा). **R.S. Bisht** excavated **Dholavira** (धोलावीरा).
6. **V.S. Wakankar** established **Bhimbetka** (भीमबेटका) rock-art prehistory in **1957–58**. Bhimbetka is in **Madhya Pradesh**, not Uttar Pradesh.
7. **Sanauli** (सनौली) (Baghpat, UP), excavated in **2018**, yielded copper **chariots**, coffins, and antenna swords in a Late Harappan / OCP setting.
8. **Alamgirpur** is the **easternmost** Harappan site in India. **Rakhigarhi** (राखीगढ़ी) (Haryana) is the largest mound — it is **not** UP and **not** the eastern edge.
9. **Mandi** (Muzaffarnagar, UP) is **not Manda** (Chenab belt, J&K). Mixing the two names is a frequent trap.
10. **Robert Bruce Foote** at **Pallavaram** in **1863** first recognised Indian Paleolithic tools.
11. **Mehrgarh** (मेहरगढ़) (Balochistan) is pre-Harappan farming and is **not** an Indian-state match option.
12. **Megalithic** burials with large stones belong mainly to the Iron-age **south**. They are not a Harappan city label.
13. **Thermoluminescence (TL)** dates fired pottery or bricks by asking when the object was last heated. Use relative methods to order a trench; use C-14 or TL when the stem wants a calendar band.
14. **Typology** matches pottery and tool shapes across sites as another relative clock beside stratigraphy.
15. **John Marshall** served as DG from **1902 to 1928** and made ASI a standing scientific department.
16. **Mortimer Wheeler** served as DG from **1944 to 1948** and brought the **balk-and-grid** excavation method.
17. **Typology** (प्रकारिकी) (pottery shape, tool type) sits beside layers as another relative clock.
18. **Willard Libby** opened the radiocarbon path that led to the 1949 Nobel recognition, and the method has been in use since the late 1940s.
19. **Bhimbetka** is in **Madhya Pradesh** as a UNESCO rock-shelter complex, not a Uttar Pradesh site.
20. **Rakhigarhi** lies in **Hisar, Haryana**, and is the largest Indus mound — it is **not** in Uttar Pradesh.
21. **Mehrgarh** is in Balochistan and marks pre-Harappan farming; it is not an Indian-state match option.
22. **Sanauli** in Baghpat, excavated in **2018**, yielded copper **chariots**, coffins, and antenna swords in a Late Harappan / OCP setting.
23. **Koldihwa** and **Mahagara** on the Belan near Prayagraj are Neolithic sites with an early **rice** claim.
24. **Hastinapur** in Meerut is a PGW and Kuru mound linked with Lal's flood-layer story.
25. **Kaushambi** near Prayagraj is the Vatsa capital with a Mauryan–Gupta stack; the Allahabad pillar stone was moved from here.
26. **Ahichchhatra** in Bareilly is the Panchala mound.
27. **Sarnath** at Varanasi is the first-sermon site with the Ashokan lion capital and was one of Cunningham's hunting grounds.
28. **Rajghat** preserves the old Kashi rampart.
29. **Shravasti** at Sahet-Mahet is the Kosala and Jetavana card.
30. **Atranjikhera** in Etah is a PGW type-site.
31. **OCP** (Ochre Coloured Pottery) marks the eastern doab Chalcolithic horizon and often pairs with **Copper Hoard** finds.
32. **PGW** (Painted Grey Ware) is the classic **Later Vedic** north Indian ware; Hastinapur and Atranjikhera are type mounds.

33. **NBPW** (Northern Black Polished Ware) rises with second urbanisation from about the **sixth century BCE** and remains thick in **Mauryan** cities.
34. **Megalithic** burials with large stones belong mainly to the Iron-age **south**; they are not a Harappan city label.
35. **Rakhigarhi** in Haryana is the largest Indus mound in India and is **not** in Uttar Pradesh.

Chapter 16: Ancient India Miscellaneous

🎯 Consolidated Must-Score Facts

1. **Mesopotamia** sits on the **Tigris–Euphrates**, runs competing **city-states**, writes **cuneiform** on clay, and builds stepped **ziggurat** temple-towers — not tombs.
2. **Egypt** sits on the **Nile**, is a unified **pharaoh** monarchy, writes **hieroglyphs** on papyrus, and builds **pyramid** royal tombs.
3. **Indus / Harappan** Mature phase is about **2600–1900 BCE**. Signatures include grid streets, baked brick, drains, and standard weights. The script is still **undeciphered**.
4. **Shang China** on the **Yellow River** uses readable **oracle-bone** script and ritual bronze **ding** vessels. Unlike the Indus script, Shang writing **is** read.
5. **Charvaka ≠ Charaka**. Charaka is the Ayurveda compiler; Charvaka is the materialist school. Mixing the names is the cheap trap.
6. **Rudrama Devi** ruled as a reigning queen under the male throne-name **Rudradeva Maharaja**. She is Ganapati's daughter, not a Chola queen.
7. **Warangal–Ramchandra Dev** is **NOT** matched. Ramachandra is the **Yadava** of **Devagiri**. Warangal's last Kakatiya is **Prataparudra II**.
8. **Thousand Pillar Temple** at Hanamkonda belongs to **Rudradeva** (tradition **1163**). It is **not** inside Warangal fort.
9. **Ramappa (Rudreshwara) Temple** at **Palampet** (Telangana) was built in **1213** under Ganapati's general Recharla Rudra and became **UNESCO** World Heritage in **2021**.
10. **Meluhha** in Mesopotamian texts is commonly linked with the Indus. Harappan Gulf trade sits with **Dilmun / Magan** memory — not a named UP river dock.
11. **Ajivika** doctrine centres on **Makkhali Gosala** and fatalist **niyati**. Barabar caves were gifted to Ajivikas under Ashoka's age — not to Buddhists.
12. **Upapuranas** are the eighteen minor Puranas beside the eighteen Mahapuranas. Use Puranas as genealogy supplements to inscriptions, not as year-perfect chronicles.
13. **Charaka** = medicine. **Sushruta** = surgery.
14. **Minoan** Crete uses Linear A, which is unread.
15. **Mycenaean** Greece uses Linear B, which is early Greek.
16. **Achaemenid Persia** uses satraps and the Royal Road.
17. **Vishnu Purana** (विष्णु पुराण) preserves a **Mauryan** (मौर्य) genealogy. Statement 1 is **true**.
18. **Matsya Purana** (मत्स्य पुराण) gives the longest **Andhra / Satavahana** (सातवाहन) king list, about **30** names and about **460** years.
19. **Vayu Purana** (वायु पुराण) is used for early dynastic lists, including Gupta **names**. It does **not** give a usable Gupta **system of governance**. Statement 2 is **false**.
20. **Purana Qila** in Delhi is a **fort** name (Humayun / Sher Shah fabric). It is not a Sanskrit text.
21. **Ajita Kesakambalin** in the Pali canon is a materialist: the person ends at death, four elements scatter. Same family of thought, Buddhist naming.
22. **Buddhism** (बौद्ध धर्म) is not materialist. It keeps **karma and rebirth**. It denies a permanent soul, which is a different denial.
23. **Nyaya** (Gautama) and **Vaisheshika** (वैशेषिक) (Kanada) are orthodox *darshanas*. They are not Charvaka.
24. **Malik Kafur** under Alauddin Khalji takes tribute at Warangal in **1310**.
25. **Ramachandra** is the **Yadava** king of **Devagiri** (the man Alauddin squeezed).
26. **Thousand Pillar Temple** (Rudreshwara) at **Hanamkonda** — consecration tradition **1163 CE**.
27. **Rudradeva / Prataparudra I** is the 12th-century male ruler. **Rudrama Devi** is his granddaughter, a century later.
28. **Motupalli** (Andhra coast): issues an **abhaya-shasana** — a safety-charter for sea merchants.
29. **1310:** Malik Kafur. Tribute, including the later **Koh-i-noor tradition** (a story, not an inscription).
30. **1323:** Ulugh Khan takes Warangal. Dynasty ends. Persian chronicles then scatter his end.
31. **Warangal Fort**: stone/laterite circuit.
32. **Perini Shivatandavam**: warrior-Shiva dance later reconstructed and tied to Kakatiya camps.

33. **Sushruta Samhita** is **surgery**, including rhinoplasty in the tradition.
34. **Vayu Purana = Gupta administration** → false. 2023 Q29 Only 1.
35. **Shriparvatiya = Vakataka** → **Ikshvaku** (Nagarjunakonda).